



# Brand Guidelines

Updated November 2024



Dear Colleagues,

Most successful marketing and communication efforts rest on narrative, that is, an accessible, authentic, and compelling story about the person, the product, or the institution. This is as true for universities as it is for any other entity or endeavor.

Such a narrative is a key element of a university's ability to position itself in a competitive landscape and enhance its reputation. The most effective narratives are those that 1) are grounded in the realities experienced by those within and outside of the community and representative of the community's aspirations; 2) surface distinctive and unique elements of the institution that set it apart from others; and 3) are consistently expressed across channels, audiences, and various university segments.

Working with a leading brand management firm specializing in higher education, SimpsonScarborough, we developed such a strategic narrative message, anchored in rigorous

research and surveys, for NYU. It has been discussed with and approved by senior leadership and the deans. We now turn to the task of infusing that message into the many communication flows emanating from the University—not just from central sources, but from the schools and administrative units—in a way that helps advance departmental agendas within the framework of a consistent portrayal of NYU's "personality," strengths, and values.

These guidelines, along with the many other NYU brand identity tools available, aim to provide guidance on matters such as tone, content, visuals, and story selection to highlight the activities and passions of our students, faculty, administrators, staff, and alumni. The aim is not homogeneity but what might be called "consanguinity"—the sense that there is a common bond or thread running through the University in how we approach our mission, value the people in our community, and strive to have an impact in the world.

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# INTRODUCTION

## In this section:

- You Are Part of the NYU Story
- The Purpose of These Brand Identity Guidelines
- Who These Guidelines Are For
- The Research Behind These Guidelines



# **YOU ARE PART OF THE NYU STORY.**

---

**NYU IS A PLACE WHERE PEOPLE FROM  
AROUND THE WORLD AND AROUND THE  
BLOCK GATHER TO LEARN, INNOVATE,  
AND COLLABORATE TO MAKE AN IMPACT.**

# OUR LONG-STANDING COMMITMENT TO OPPORTUNITY AND CONNECTION BEGAN IN 1831,

when NYU was founded as an alternative to elitist universities for the emerging middle class of New York City.

## SINCE THEN,

NYU has grown to become the largest private research university in the United States and one of the most recognized universities across the globe.

**YOU INFLUENCE  
HOW WE **ENDURE  
AND EVOLVE:****

**EVERY DAY THAT  
YOU ARE PART  
OF THE NYU  
COMMUNITY IS  
A DAY **YOU HELP  
SHAPE ITS FUTURE.****

You are part of the NYU story, and how we tell that story is an important element of how we continue to share NYU's opportunities and achievements with the world.

**650,000+ Alumni**

**55,000+ Students**

**6,000+ Full-Time Faculty**

**15,000+ Employees**

**140+ Countries Represented**

**6,000+ Courses Offered**

**20 Schools and Colleges**

**12 Global Academic Centers and Programs**

**3 Degree-Granting Campuses**

# 1 UNIVERSITY.

Whether or not our title includes the word “communications,” we all tell the NYU story in some form, and while we represent many different areas and entities of the University, we are ultimately one NYU.



## Introduction

The Purpose of These Brand Identity Guidelines

# The Purpose of These Brand Identity Guidelines

Consistent brand expression reinforces our collective commitment to the academic mission we support as well as the perception of NYU as a global and connected institution.

These guidelines explain how the NYU brand identity was created. At its foundation, it is built out of our values and the things that make us unique. It brings together our verbal expression (how we sound) and visual expression (how we look) to showcase a consistent NYU identity that generates awareness, reinforces the strength of our reputation, and scales our ability to draw in and engage our audiences.

# Who These Guidelines Are For

01

Anyone at NYU who communicates on the University’s behalf on any platform can find guidance and ideas here.

02

Communicators can use it to provide examples for the creation of new, impactful stories.

03

Writers can use it to draw inspiration when they create stories about the achievements of their individual departments.

04

Designers can use the color palette, typography, and photography and design elements to give life to their creations.

It is likely that your school or division has a central communications team who is familiar with this set of resources. As a first step, we strongly encourage you to contact that team to ensure your communications align with your unit’s broader strategic plan.



# The Research Behind These Guidelines

These guidelines are the product of extensive qualitative and quantitative research including competitive benchmarks and reputational studies among all of our audiences.

Working with a leading brand management firm specializing in higher education, SimpsonScarborough, we developed a compelling, distinctive, and strategic narrative message, anchored in rigorous research and surveys, for NYU. It has been discussed with and approved by senior leadership and the deans.

The outcome of this research was distilled into four insights that shape the NYU narrative and brand strategy, called strategic drivers. These drivers in turn were used to create a unique messaging platform, which is discussed in depth in the following section, The NYU Messaging Platform.

## Steps to Building a Unique Messaging Platform

**Step 1** Research

We captured qualitative and quantitative data to measure perceptions of the institution across different audience groups.

**Step 2** Strategic Drivers

We distilled the research findings into four distinguishing insights—strategic drivers—to drive the university narrative and messaging platform.

**Step 3** Messaging Platform

We used the strategic drivers to inform our framework for institution-wide communications.

# Strategic Drivers

|                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Strategic Driver 1                                                                             | Key Research Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Strategic Driver 3                                                            | Key Research Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Leverage the power and benefits of NYU’s vibrant urban locations to enhance academic prestige. | Surveyed audiences commonly used the word “urban” to describe NYU and viewed NYU’s metropolitan locations and the idea of “being at the center of everything” as a powerful and distinctive factor in NYU’s academic reputation.                                        | Lean into the archetype of the independent, driven intellectual.              | NYU students, faculty, administrators, staff, and alumni most often described themselves as independent, self-driven, and intellectual. This opens up the opportunity to build a greater sense of community with this particular personality type in mind. |
| Strategic Driver 2                                                                             | Key Research Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Strategic Driver 4                                                            | Key Research Findings                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Increase associations with academic rigor and impact.                                          | Despite being a top research university, reputation studies revealed our internal audiences strongly associate NYU with location-based traits such as urban dynamism, diversity, and globalism that overshadow academic traits such as rigor, research, and innovation. | Continue to accentuate NYU’s strength and reputation as a global institution. | All surveyed audiences used the word “global” to describe NYU and strongly associated the institution with “global impact.” This was not true for NYU’s competitors and offers the opportunity to reinforce NYU’s position in this space.                  |

# THE NYU MESSAGING PLATFORM

## In this section:

Telling the NYU Story

Messaging Platform

NYU's Personality

# Telling the NYU Story

Our brand strategy is the cornerstone for all verbal and visual guidance for NYU.

It informs how we speak, sound, look, and feel across written and visual communications.



# Messaging Platform

The messaging platform is an organized snapshot of important communication components that inform the distinctive NYU narrative.

It’s an effective way for us to identify what messages we communicate that both distinguish the university image and portray NYU in a consistent manner.

The messaging platform contains three major elements: our brand essence, pillars, and foundation.

## Brand Essence

Owning our place at the center of everything

Our **brand essence** is a phrase that captures the heart of the messaging platform in one thought. It is the concept from which the rest of our thinking stems. The brand essence is *never* explicitly articulated in communications but our audiences should *feel* it.

## Pillars

1

Fueling ambition and fostering connection to transform lives

2

Creating ideas with impact

3

Elevated by the intensity of great cities

Our **brand pillars** reflect our strengths, what we stand for, and what sets us apart from our competition. (Refer to page 19 for more information.)

## Foundation

- Internationally recognized research university
- Well-known schools of law, medicine, the arts, business, public health, and more
- Produces career-ready graduates and numerous notable alumni
- World-class, expert faculty from around the globe
- Deep commitment to diversity, inclusion, and social mobility

Our **foundation** is made of our strongest non-differentiating pride points that shape who we are and how we portray NYU to the world.



## Brand Essence

# Owning our place at the center of everything

### **“Owning our place...”**

In reputation the research shows NYU is near the top of many people’s lists, clustered with just a handful of other prestigious liberal arts universities. Forging a distinctive space of its own within this set is NYU’s goal. Much like the people who make up the NYU community, the institution values embracing diverse backgrounds and perspectives and taking an independent stance in the world.

### **“...at the center of everything”**

From its heart in New York City, NYU has built its presence in more than a dozen cities worldwide that possess similar traits: action, energy, strength, opportunity, and thought leadership. This unmatched urban network means NYU and its people are always where the world’s big ideas are being discussed, fostering innovation. Incomparable challenges exist alongside unrivaled opportunities here, but like our cities, our people have the unique resolve and fortitude to surmount anything.

# Pillars

Our brand pillars distinguish NYU from the competition and reinforce our brand essence.

These pillars take the form of three differentiating strengths that communicate who we are, what we do, and how we do it.

| Pillar 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Pillar 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Pillar 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Fueling ambition and fostering connection to transform lives.</b></p> <p>Founded with a mission to be open to all, we imbue an unparalleled education with resources that grant opportunity and agency to a diverse, global university community.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <p><b>Creating ideas with impact.</b></p> <p>More than a global collection of places, NYU is an electric network of exceptionally smart, intensely curious people devoted to creating novel ideas and solutions in rigorous academic environments.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <p><b>Elevated by the intensity of great cities.</b></p> <p>Founded in New York City, one of the world's most dynamic cities, we embrace and embody the spirit, strength, and vibrancy of great cities around the world, reflecting the intellectual energy derived from engaging with a complex range of people, ideas, and disciplines.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>Why We Claim This</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Diversity and freedom of thought, perspectives, and people not only comprise a core value of the institution but create a stronger academic experience.</li><li>• Current and prospective students believe that NYU excels at providing opportunity to a passionately independent student body.</li><li>• NYU was founded with a mission to provide an education “opened to all,” which separates it from an elitist peer set.</li><li>• Free from the restraints of tradition, NYU is better poised than most for nimble impact.</li></ul> | <p><b>Why We Claim This</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Creativity and innovation happen at NYU locations across the globe, where students and faculty ask questions that are answered through the intentional practice of research, art, and science.</li><li>• Internal audiences believe NYU to be a place that is filled with people as bold, dynamic, and opportunistic as the cities it inhabits—reflecting back to those cities a similar entrepreneurial spirit.</li><li>• The sheer reach of NYU—both globally and programmatically—speaks to an unquenched thirst to learn and do more.</li></ul> | <p><b>Why We Claim This</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Experiential learning elevates academic excellence at NYU.</li><li>• Intellectual immersion occurs in centers of life, and NYU is at the nexus of these academic and human forces.</li><li>• The institution provides unmatched access to worldwide hubs of culture, business, and talent, which translates into an education like no other.</li><li>• More than any other statement, internal audiences believe that NYU is a place where character-building challenges and opportunities are intertwined.</li></ul> |

# NYU's Personality

Our personality is composed of the traits and characteristics that set us apart from other institutions.

It represents how we embody and promote our core values and institutional position and attitudes. We can express our personality both verbally (how we sound) and visually (how we look).

## NYU is...



**Independent and Driven**  
Satisfied in no one's shadow



**Curious and Courageous**  
Unafraid to ask hard questions



**Cosmopolitan and Vibrant**  
Infusing our cities with new energy



**Tenacious and Resilient**  
Possessing the grit to persevere



# OUR VERBAL EXPRESSION

**In this section:**

How We Sound

Writing in Our Voice

Tone of Voice

# How We Sound Our Voice

When communicating on behalf of NYU, we want the stories we tell and how we tell them to reflect our personality. To do so, we use NYU’s voice.



## NYU Content Strategy

For more information about NYU’s verbal expression, refer to the Content Strategy at [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).

# How Our Personality Translates Into Our Voice

| Our personality is...  | So our voice is...         |
|------------------------|----------------------------|
| Independent & Driven   | Informative & Encouraging  |
| Curious & Courageous   | Inspirational & Advocative |
| Cosmopolitan & Vibrant | Understanding & Energetic  |
| Tenacious & Resilient  | Optimistic & Open-Minded   |

# Independent & Driven

Satisfied in no one’s shadow

Our voice is...

## Informative

We don’t always follow the beaten path, and neither does our community. We create informative content because knowing about NYU’s resources and opportunities empowers our community to be independent and forge their own path.

## Encouraging

We’re familiar with the energy that comes from inner motivation, and we galvanize our audiences to leverage their potential with the help of NYU resources—while making it clear that guidance is always available to help them achieve their goals.

This is how our audiences should perceive us in all forms of communications.

Our voice is not...

## Selfish

## Arrogant

## Self-Serving

## Hesitant

## Lazy

Avoid words and phrases that may make our audiences perceive us as the adjectives listed above.

# Curious & Courageous

Unafraid to ask hard questions

Our voice is...

## Inspirational

We’re always asking the next question and believe that discovery is never finite. We mentally and emotionally inspire our audiences and promote creative thinking.

## Advocative

Unafraid to push for what is right, we encourage advocating for those who can’t advocate for themselves, and we do not shy away from difficult questions and thoughts.

This is how our audiences should perceive us in all forms of communications.

Our voice is not...

## Intrusive

## Apathetic

## Controlling

## Combative

## Brash

Avoid words and phrases that may make our audiences perceive us as the adjectives listed above.

# Cosmopolitan & Vibrant

Infusing our cities with new energy

Our voice is...

## Understanding

As a global-minded and cosmopolitan community, we value our many perspectives and experiences. We share important stories that foster deeper connection.

## Energetic

This is the university that never sleeps, that hums with possibility and drive. We bring out this energy in others through dynamic storytelling and communication.

This is how our audiences should perceive us in all forms of communications.

Our voice is not...

## Pedantic

## Pretentious

## Passive

## Dull

## Disengaged

Avoid words and phrases that may make our audiences perceive us as the adjectives listed above.

# Tenacious & Resilient

Possessing the grit to persevere

Our voice is...

## Optimistic

We believe challenges and adversity are part of the processes of life and progress. They strengthen our convictions, and so we acknowledge the negative—and learn from it—while choosing to focus on the positive and the long view.

## Open-Minded

Challenges don't defeat us—they teach us to find new solutions and new futures. Disagreements don't upset us—they help us recognize diverse perspectives. Our willingness to seek understanding informs solutions and cultivates inspiration.

This is how our audiences should perceive us in all forms of communications.

Our voice is not...

## Stubborn

## Cynical

## Reactive

## Easily Disheartened

## Complacent

Avoid words and phrases that may make our audiences perceive us as the adjectives listed above.

# Writing in Our Voice

**The content and character of your communication should always reflect NYU’s personality and values. This helps set us apart from other institutions and establish trust with our audiences.**

To embody NYU’s independent, driven, curious, courageous, cosmopolitan, vibrant, tenacious, and resilient personality traits, craft informative, encouraging, inspirational, advocative, understanding, energetic, optimistic, and open-minded content. This is our voice.

When you are writing in NYU’s voice, do you have to embody all of these characteristics at once? Not necessarily.

But you will probably tap into several of them each time you use it. If what you write taps into three or more of these characteristics, then you’ve likely used the NYU voice successfully.

## Examples of Our Voice

“Big ideas emerge from big cities. Big thinkers come from NYU. Attracting over \$400 million in external research and academic support each year, our community is doing work that makes a recognizable impact. In every field, we push the boundaries of knowledge in our mission to make the world more connected, safe, and just.

**Why This Is Successful**

This paragraph is informative, advocative, inspirational, and energetic. It is the kind of copy you might use for prospective graduate and undergraduate students, faculty, or staff.

“Make. Change. Lead. We know who we are and what world we want to live in. We find strength in the many voices and perspectives of our community, and we believe that being true to ourselves and good to each other is the best way forward. We’ve been waiting for the moment to do something big—bigger than ourselves—and now is our time.

**Why This Is Successful**

This paragraph is energetic, advocative, inspirational, optimistic, and understanding. It is the kind of copy you might use to frame a call to action for an event that hinges on idealism and requires the NYU community’s participation—perhaps a hackathon, conference, forum, or festival.

# Tone of Voice

Our audiences will interact with us for different reasons, so we can’t expect to communicate with everyone the same way. Tone allows us to adapt our voice to maximize audience understanding, receptivity, and engagement.

For example, our voice will always be informative, but our tone can vary from direct and responsible to more discursive and playful in the delivery of information. Tone is not mutually exclusive; our tone can combine different attitudes to craft a texture for the message that is unique yet remarkably NYU.

**Note:** If the tone of your crafted message falls within the tonal range highlighted on the right, it is genuine to NYU’s personality and voice.

## Our Tone

As an institution of higher education, we are accountable for and to the many people who make up our community, so our communications should sound **responsible** and **objective**. We should not only come across as informative and accessible but also **playful\*** and **imaginative**, reflecting the inventive and creative spirits of the 15 locations we call home while being careful not to offer attractive but empty promises.

NYU believes we can move society forward but doing so requires an equal blend of realism and optimism. Therefore, our communications should be honest and clear but not insensitive and unfeeling. Approach complications and conflicts when necessary with a **practical** attitude while applying

an **idealistic**, aspirational tone to inspire future innovation and change that are grounded in reality. If you have a lot of ideas to cover, communicating in a **discursive** style is fine but keep it topical and easy to follow. Be **direct** and avoid overly verbose or dense communications.

Although we have a strong sense of right and wrong, we always keep an open mind. **Conscientious** communications demonstrate our compassion and understanding while a **casual\*** attitude suggests flexibility. Always come across as caring, but steer clear of sensational emotional appeals. Choose to sound mindful and engaged over nonchalant and disinterested.

\*When taking a more playful or casual tone, *avoid* impersonating student voices. Be cautious when using slang terms—meaning can shift very quickly and their use can sometimes perpetuate cultural appropriation.



# Examples of Our Tone

The following examples convey the same general information for prospective undergraduate students and embody the NYU personality and voice but do so using a different dominant tone.

## Idealistic



Unparalleled education creates unprecedented opportunity. With over 250 areas of study, thousands of undergraduate courses, and locations around the world, at NYU, you'll find the knowledge and the tools you need to change the world and become the person you were meant to be.

## Playful



Indecisively curious or endlessly ambitious? Either way, NYU suits you. Change course, add minors, take on a second major. With so many options, you have the power to explore different disciplines or create your ideal educational experience. Here, you have the flexibility and the freedom to become who you were meant to be—your way.

## Objective



NYU offers you myriad ways to pursue your academic and personal goals. More than 250 areas of study, 3,000 undergraduate courses, and 300 student-run clubs allow you to mix and match your interests across disciplines. What's more, you can take your education global by studying away at any of our 14 additional global locations. Conduct groundbreaking research. Learn a new language. Launch a grassroots organization. You can do all this and more at NYU.



# OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

## In this section:

How We Look

Logos, Lockups, and the University Seal

Visual Tone Spectrum

Color

Typography

Graphics

Photography

Video

OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# How We Look



# How We Look

Our visual expression is how we embody the NYU identity and personality through design and visual elements.

To be successful, our visual expression must:

Express the brand messaging platform and essence

Be distinctive enough to stand on its own, set us apart from our competition, and be easily recognized as NYU

Connect on an emotional level with internal and external audiences

Offer enough flexibility for the university-wide community to use

**THE RESULT WAS INSPIRED BY THE  
STREETS OF THE CITIES NYU CALLS HOME,  
THE CONNECTIONS AND COLLABORATIONS  
BETWEEN THE PEOPLE IN OUR COMMUNITY,  
THE INTERSECTION OF IDEAS ON OUR  
CAMPUSES AND IN OUR CLASSROOMS,  
AND THE DRIVE AND CURIOSITY THAT  
PUSHES EACH OF US TO KEEP EXPLORING  
THE OPPORTUNITIES AROUND US AND  
WITHIN OURSELVES.**

Go to page 52 to explore how these concepts take shape in our visual expression.

OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# Logos, Lockups, and the University Seal



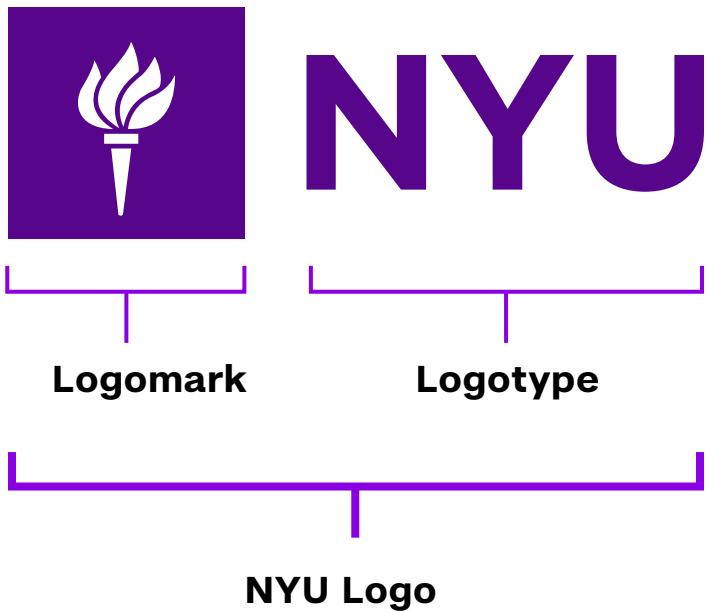
# AT NYU, WE BELIEVE IN **ENLIGHTENMENT** THROUGH **EDUCATION.**

Our flagship image, the white torch on a dark background, represents light in the darkness, or enlightenment through education. From the banners that sit atop NYU buildings across campuses and sites worldwide to print and digital communication materials, the NYU logo is one of the most visible and important representations of our brand.

Proper and consistent usage of the logo not only reinforces the University's collective reputation but lends communications added credibility when used in an appropriate manner. You will find methods of how to apply the logo, other corresponding visual elements, and the university seal in the following section.

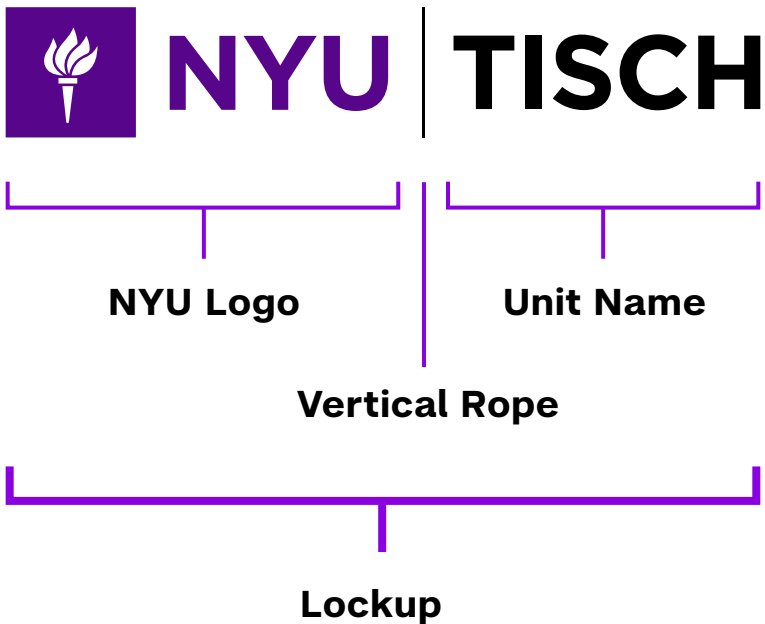
# Logos vs. Lockups

At NYU, we are all connected by one logo, which has three variations: short, long, and stacked. However, we created lockups—the combination of the NYU logo and an additional logotype—for degree-granting campuses, schools, global academic centers and programs, and offices and departments as a way to distinguish them from while also grounding them in the larger university identity.



## NYU Logo

The **NYU logo** is the combination of our logomark and logotype. Through consistent usage, we can create a distinctive, recognizable visual identity that is protected from imposter brands or unauthorized users.



## Lockups

**Lockups** contain our NYU logo and an individual unit’s name, connected by a vertical rope between them. We call these lockups within our brand system because the unit name is “locked up” next to the logo.

Units include degree-granting campuses, schools, global academic centers and programs, and offices and departments.



# All-University Logos

NYU’s all-university (all-u) logos are the University’s broadest forms of representation. They are not affiliated with any specific institutional unit.



### The NYU All-U Logo Kit

Our logo kit includes all three versions of the all-u logo in the following file types: .jpeg, .png, and .eps.

Download the All-U Logo Kit from [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).

 **Accessibility Note**  
For the long version of the logo, set **alt text** to “New York University.” For the short and stacked versions of the logo, set alt text to “NYU.” It is not necessary to note the version (short, long, stacked) or color of the logo.



**Short Logo (Primary)**  
The short version is the primary NYU logo. It is used for central administration business communications, and it is easily recognized at a variety of sizes for both print and digital communications.



**Long Logo**  
The long version is used for external audiences, for whom the full university name conveys additional information. It is also used if the communication would benefit from a more formal approach.



**Stacked Logo**  
The stacked version of the logo is used in a few instances when the final size is too small or too large, such as small digital applications or large outdoor flag applications.

# Degree-Granting Campus Lockups

NYU’s degree-granting campuses each have unique aspects, but they are ultimately connected to create one NYU. Their lockups reflect this unity.

 **Accessibility Note**  
For NYU Abu Dhabi lockups, set the **alt text** in your communication to “NYU Abu Dhabi.” For NYU Shanghai, set the alt text to “NYU Shanghai.” It is not necessary to note the version (short, long, stacked) or color of the lockup or the Arabic script or Chinese characters.



**NYU Abu Dhabi**  
When using these lockups and other branding elements, refer to the [NYU Abu Dhabi Brand Guidelines](#).  
Download Abu Dhabi lockups from [nyu.edu/brand](#).



**NYU Shanghai**  
When using the Shanghai lockup, make sure to use the version on the left that contains the torch logomark. For communications within China, please contact [NYU Shanghai University Communications](#).  
Download Shanghai lockups from [nyu.edu/brand](#).

# School Lockups

Each school has three official lockup variations that should be used in place of the all-university logos.

Most schools have specific guidance on their branding. Visit [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand) for a complete list of school branding pages and to download school lockups.

 **Accessibility Note**  
For short and stacked school lockups, set **alt text** to “NYU [School Shorthand Name].” For long school lockups, write out the full school name, “NYU [School Name].”



## Short School Lockup (Primary)

Short school lockups use the school’s shorthand name most commonly used by students, faculty, and staff. This version creates a strong graphical mark, is more flexible, and is easily recognized at a distance or in small sizes.



## Long School Lockup

The long version, or formal lockup, includes the school’s full name and is best used in instances when additional descriptive information will add value to the communication.



## Stacked School Lockup

The stacked version of the short school lockup can be used to accommodate more compact locations such as social media profile images.

**Our Visual Expression**  
Logos, Lockups, and the University Seal



College of Arts and Science



College of Dentistry



Courant Institute of Mathematical Sciences



Gallatin School of Individualized Study



Graduate School of Arts and Science



Institute for the Study of the Ancient World



Institute of Fine Arts



Leonard N. Stern School of Business



Liberal Studies



Robert F. Wagner Graduate School of Public Service



Rory Meyers College of Nursing



School of Global Public Health



School of Law



School of Professional Studies



Silver School of Social Work



Steinhardt School of Culture, Education, and Human Development



Tandon School of Engineering



Tisch School of the Arts

Visit [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand) for a list of school branding pages and to download school lockups.

Visit [brandcenter.med.nyu.edu](https://brandcenter.med.nyu.edu) for Long Island School of Medicine and Robert I. Grossman School of Medicine branding guidance.

# Global Academic Center and Program Lockups

Each NYU global academic center and program offers a distinct experience, but wherever you are within the global network, you’re always at NYU. Their lockups illustrate this fundamental connection.

Download global academic center and program lockups from [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).

 **Accessibility Note**

For global academic centers and programs, set the **alt text** in communications to “NYU [City Name].” It is not necessary to note the version (short, long, stacked) or color of the lockup.



## Global Academic Center and Program Lockup

Each global academic center and program has a single lockup in the color variations demonstrated on page 44. To view a complete list of global academic center and program lockups, refer to page 41.

**Our Visual Expression**  
Logos, Lockups, and the University Seal

|                                                                                                         |                                                                                                            |                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  <b>NYU</b>   ACCRA    |  <b>NYU</b>   BERLIN    |  <b>NYU</b>   BUENOS AIRES |  <b>NYU</b>   FLORENCE        |
| Accra                                                                                                   | Berlin                                                                                                     | Buenos Aires                                                                                                  | Florence                                                                                                         |
|  <b>NYU</b>   LONDON   |  <b>NYU</b>   LOS ANGELES |  <b>NYU</b>   MADRID       |  <b>NYU</b>   PARIS           |
| London                                                                                                  | Los Angeles                                                                                                | Madrid                                                                                                        | Paris                                                                                                            |
|  <b>NYU</b>   PRAGUE |  <b>NYU</b>   SYDNEY   |  <b>NYU</b>   TEL AVIV   |  <b>NYU</b>   WASHINGTON DC |
| Prague                                                                                                  | Sydney                                                                                                     | Tel Aviv                                                                                                      | Washington, DC                                                                                                   |

Download global academic center and program lockups from [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).



# Office Lockups

All NYU offices and departments have a lockup to help them maintain a strong connection with the NYU brand.

Visit [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand) to access a complete list of all office lockups and download lockups.



## Request an Office Lockup Kit

NYU Marketing Communications creates lockup kits for all new offices and departments. Lockup kits include three color versions in the following file types: **.jpeg**, **.png**, and **.eps**.

Request office lockups through the [MarComm Service Request Form](#).

### Accessibility Note

For offices and departments, set the **alt text** in communications to “NYU [Office/Department Name].” It is not necessary to note the version (short, long, stacked) or color of the lockup.



NYU

Photo  
Bureau

## Office Lockup

Using one of the all-university logos is the best way to communicate your official connection to the University. However, we created official lockups for all NYU offices and departments for certain instances when it is important to specify the entity behind the communications.



# Using Logos and Lockups

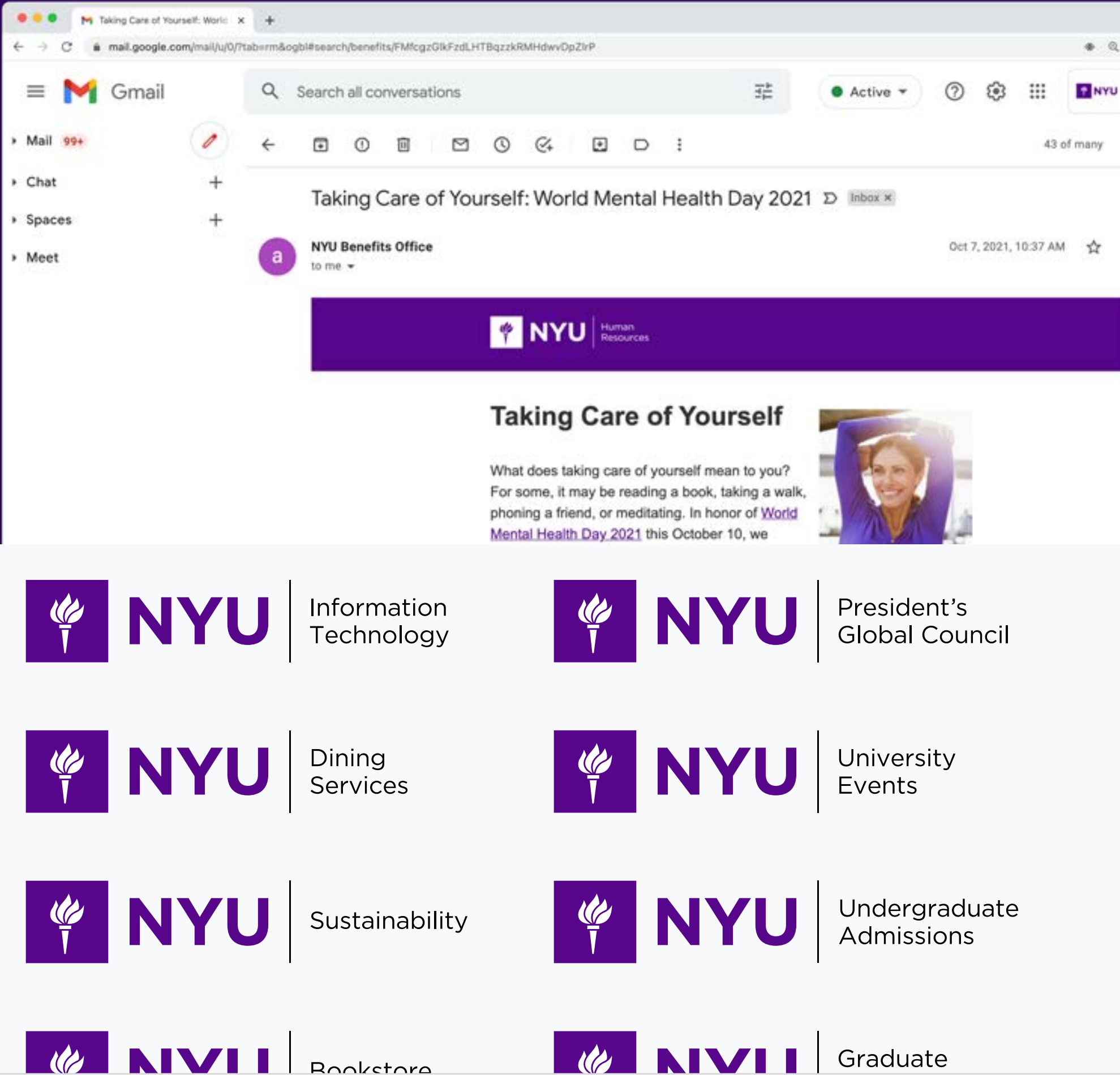
## Office Lockup Usage and Naming Conventions

### When to Use

Office lockups are used in instances when it is important for your audience to know which part of NYU is responsible for a communication. For example, an email newsletter sent out by Human Resources.

### Naming

Lockups are structured to communicate central administration affiliation with the University. Therefore, it isn't necessary to add "Office" in the name that appears in the lockup. For example, instead of "Office of Sustainability," use "Sustainability"; instead of "Office of University Events," use "University Events."



# Using Logos and Lockups

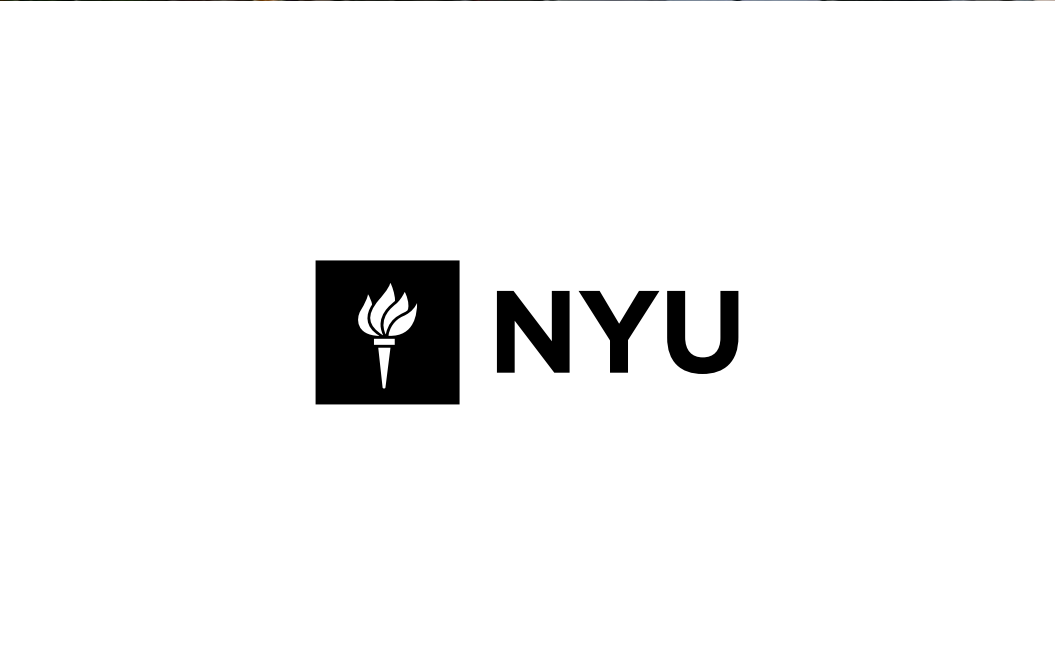
## Color Usage

All logos and lockups come in three color variations: NYU Violet (PMS 2597), white, and black.

- **NYU Violet (Primary Usage):** All logos and lockups should primarily be used in our principal brand color, NYU Violet, on white and light backgrounds. Refer to the Color section for more detailed color breakdowns.
- **White (Secondary Usage):** Logos and lockups can also be used in white on NYU Violet and darker backgrounds.
- **Black (Limited Usage):** Logos and lockups can appear in black only for black-and-white and gray scale instances.

 **Accessibility Note**

Always make sure there is enough **contrast** between the logo or lockup and the background to maintain legibility, especially when using photography.

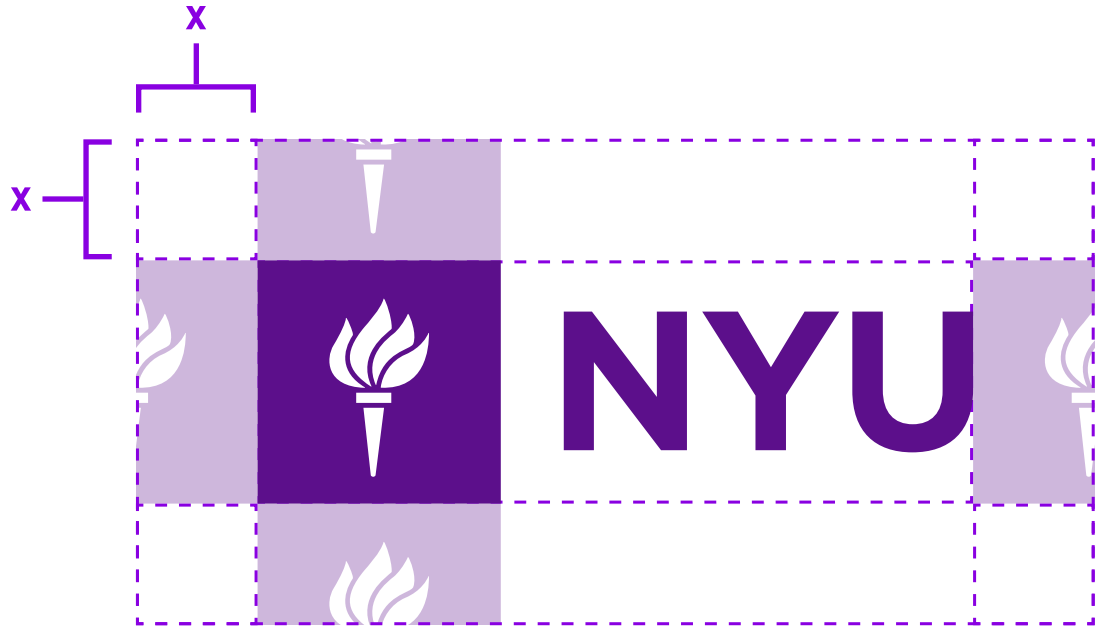


# Using Logos and Lockups

## Clear Space

Clear space is the amount of space around a logo or lockup. In the diagram to the right, **x** equals **half the height or width of the torch box**. Across all logo and lockup versions, there should be **at least x** space around it on all sides.

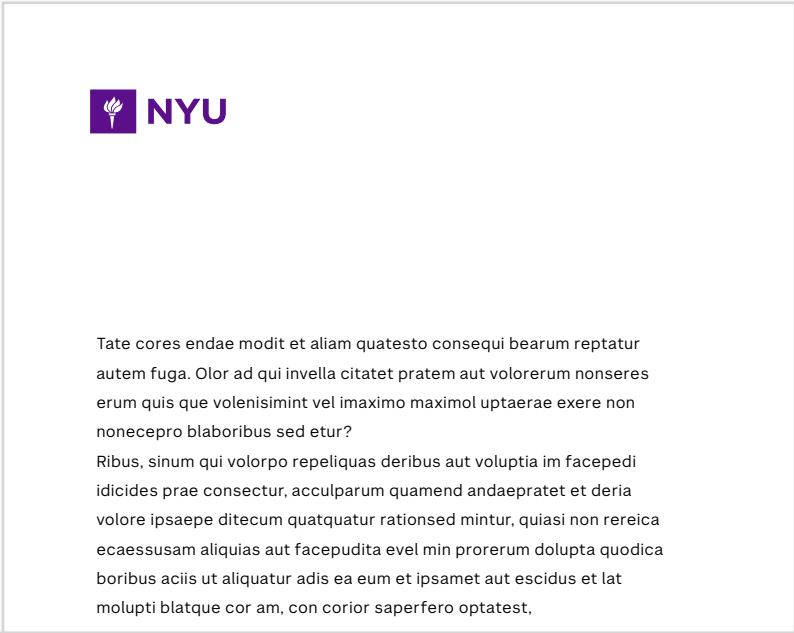
Refer to our In Action section for more contextual examples of appropriate clear space.



Logo Clear Space

### ✓ Adequate Amount of Clear Space

The logo has plenty of room on the page and does not compete for attention with other elements. By maintaining an ample amount of space around the logo, this composition feels balanced.



### ⊗ Inadequate Amount of Clear Space

The logo is compressed into the corner of the page with little room between it and other elements. The title of this document is flush with the logo, making the overall composition feel crowded.



# Using Logos and Lockups

## Sizing and Scale

### Minimum Sizes

When using logos or lockups in print, the torch box should measure at least .25 inches or 30 pixels in height (for the short and long versions) or width (for the stacked version).

### Scale

As a subtle indicator of association with the University, the logo or lockup should never be the dominant element in communications—but it also should not be too small. Instead, scale the logo or lockup in proportion with the rest of the content.

### Minimum Sizes

**Print:** .25 inches  
**Digital:** 30 pixels



### ✓ Appropriate Logo Scale



Tate cores endae modit et aliam quatesto consequi bearum reptatur autem fuga. Olor ad qui invella citatet pratem aut volorerum nonseres erum quis que volenisimint vel imaximo maximol uptaerae exere non nonecepro blaboribus sed etur?

Ribus, sinum qui volorpo repeliquas deribus aut voluptia im facepedi idicides prae consectetur, acculparum quamend andaepratet et deria volore ipsaepe ditecum quatquatur rationsed mintur, quiasi non rereica ecaessusam aliquias aut facepudita evel min prorerum dolupta quodica boribus aciis ut aliquatur adis ea eum et ipsamet aut escidus et lat molupti blatque cor am, con corior saperfero optatest,

### ⊗ Inappropriate Logo Scale



Tate cores endae modit et aliam quateso consequi bearum reptatur autem fuga. Olor ad qui invella citatet pratem aut volorerum nonseres erum quis que volenisimint vel imaximo maximol uptaerae exere non nonecepro blaboribus sed etur?

Ribus, sinum qui volorpo repeliquas deribus aut voluptia im facepedi idicides prae consectetur, acculparum quamend andaepratet et deria volore ipsaepe ditecum quatquatur rationsed mintur, quiasi non rereica



# Using Logos and Lockups Placement

The optimal logo and lockup placement varies depending on your composition as well as your medium.

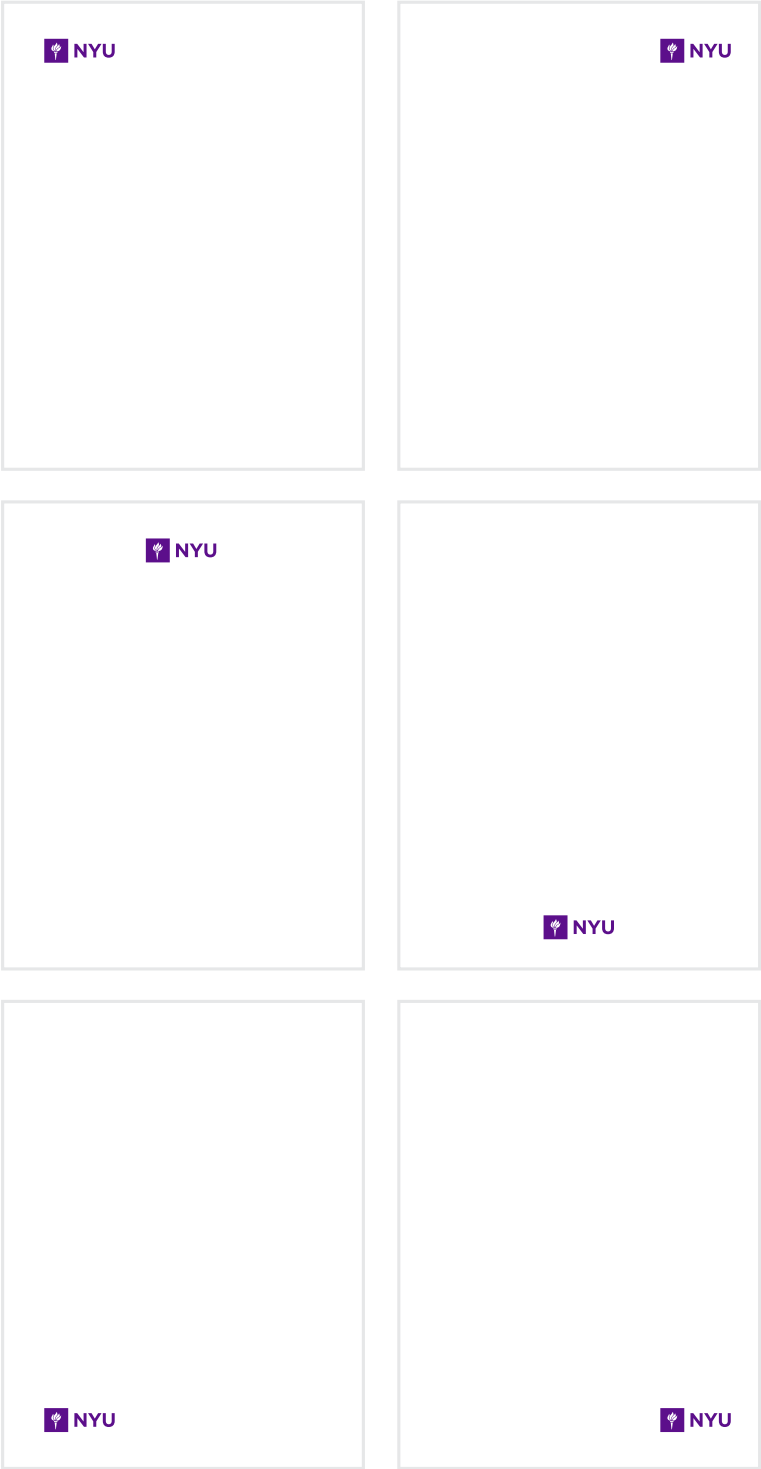
For print applications like posters and documents, position the logo or lockup along one of the composition’s edges at an appropriate size relative to the rest of the content.

In digital applications we recommend placing logos and lockups at the top of the screen. Studies show this placement maintains a brand’s recognition and recall. Avoid placing logos at the bottom of the screen.

Refer to the In Action section for contextual examples.

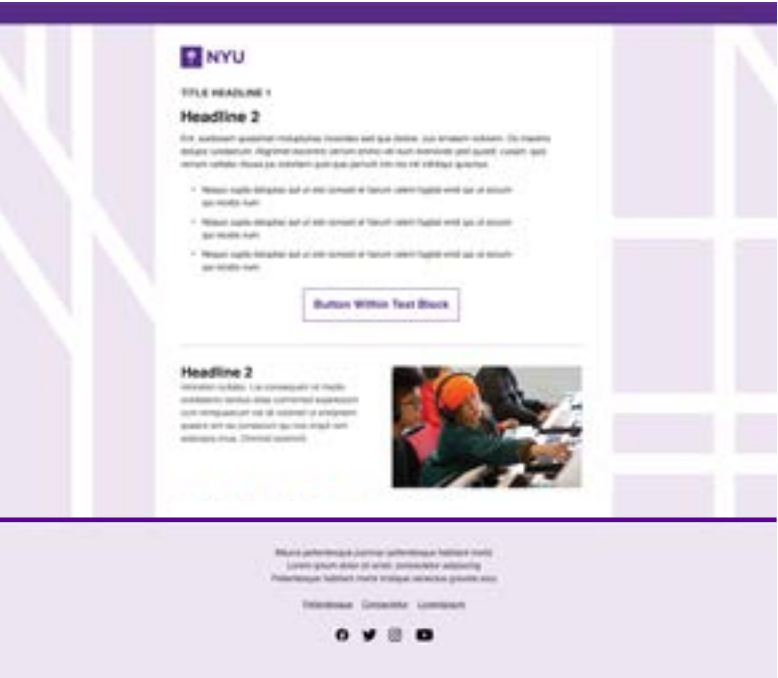
## Print

- ✓ Position a logo or lockup along one of the edges of print pieces. Let your composition inform its placement.

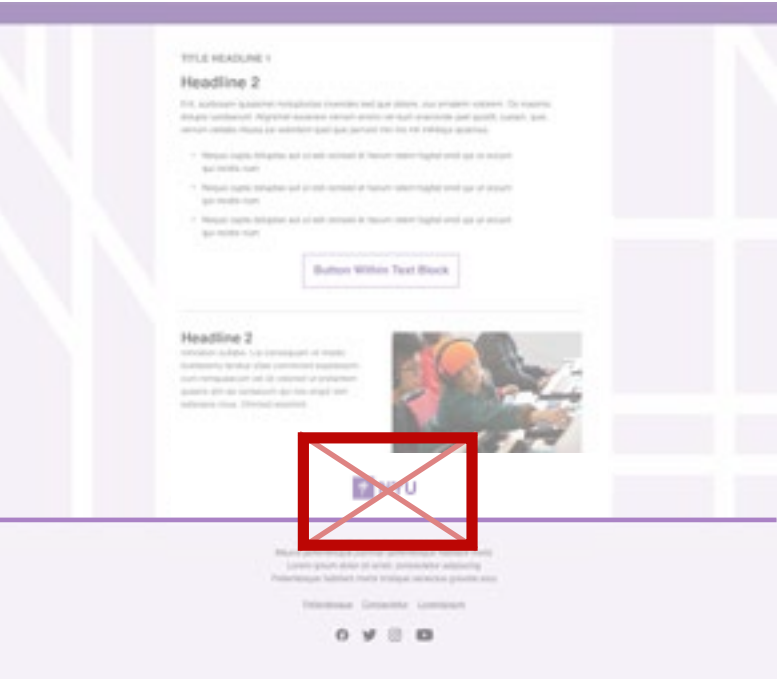


## Digital

- ✓ Place a logo or lockup at the top of digital applications like emails.



- ✗ Do not place logos or lockups at the bottom of digital applications.



# Using Logos and Lockups

## Joint Programs and Sponsorships

**Use one version of the NYU logo or lockup.**  
Do not use more than one version of the NYU logo or lockup (i.e., short, long, stacked) within the same communication.

**Use one version of the NYU logo for joint programs and sponsorships.**  
To represent multiple schools participating in a single initiative, use the NYU logo once alongside a list of the participating units.

✔ **Use one version of a logo or lockup**



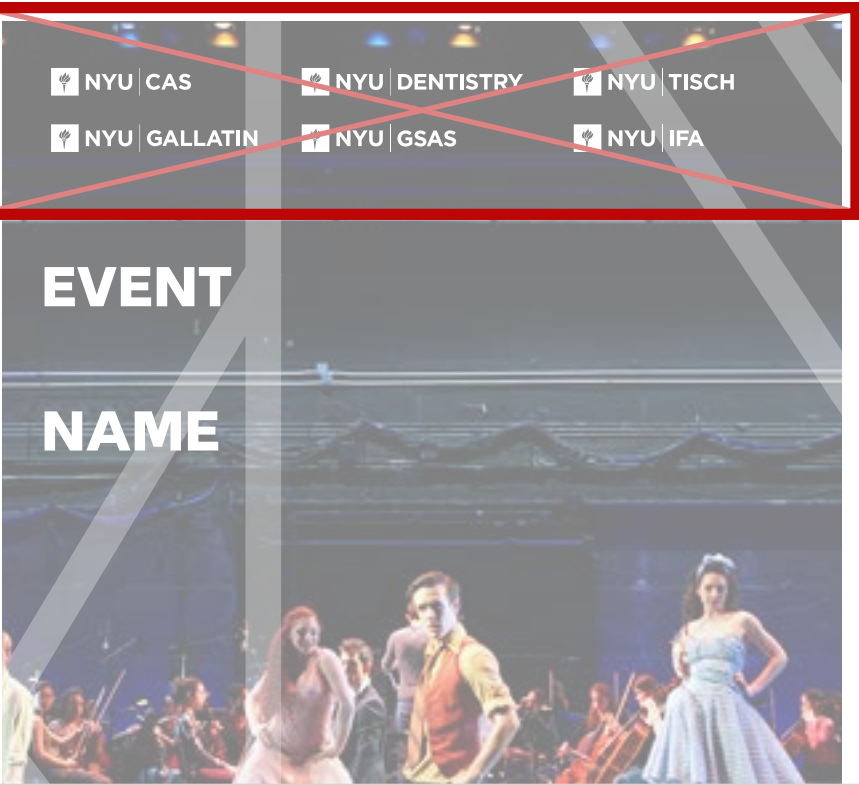
✗ **Do not use multiple versions of a logo or lockup in the same communication**



✔ **Use the NYU logo alongside participant names**



✗ **Do not use multiple school lockups**



# Using Logos and Lockups

## Incorrect Usage

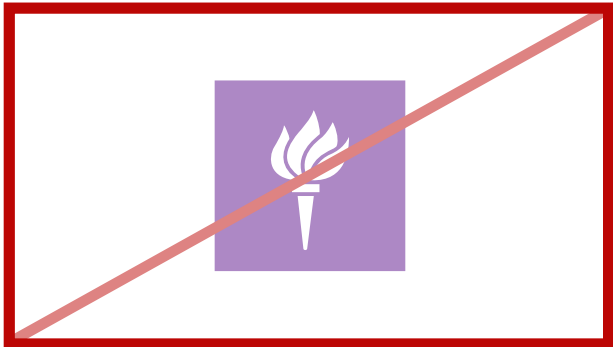
Using logos and lockups in a consistent way is important to maintain the integrity of the brand. Do not alter the logo or lockup in any way. To the right are some common mistakes to avoid.



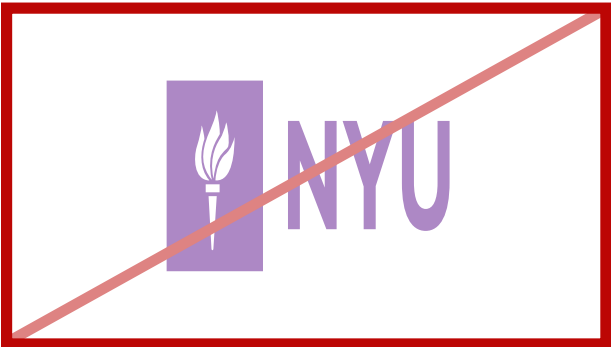
### Request an Office Lockup Kit

NYU Marketing Communications creates lockup kits for all new offices and departments. Lockup kits include three color versions in the following file types: **.jpeg**, **.png**, and **.eps**.

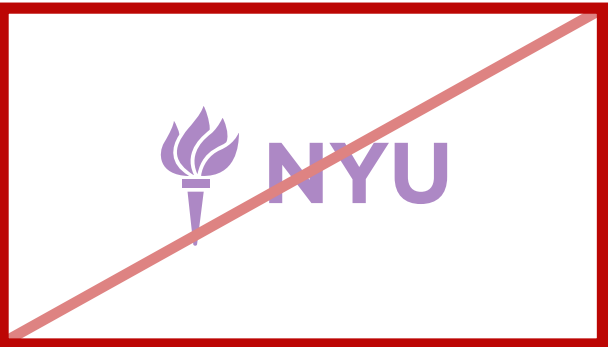
Request office lockups through the [MarComm Service Request Form](#).



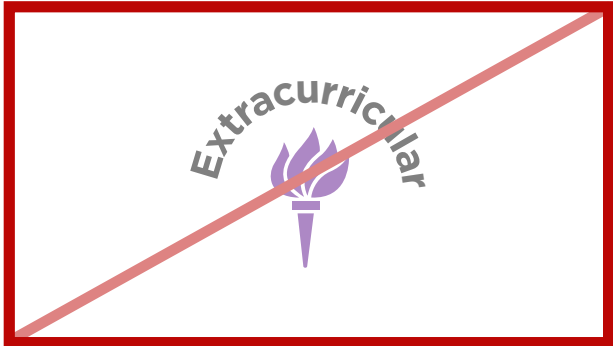
**Do not** separate the different parts of the logo.



**Do not** stretch the logo.



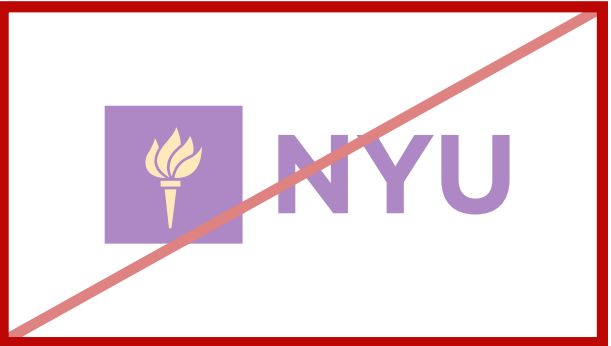
**Do not** remove the torch from the box.



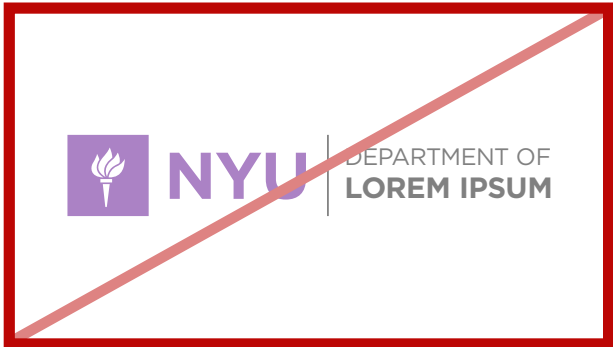
**Do not** create other logos using the torch.



**Do not** crop the torch in a different way.



**Do not** make the torch a different color.



**Do not** create your own lockups.



# Using Logos and Lockups

## Do Not Create New Logos or Lockups

The NYU logo and your unit’s lockup are powerful tools. In the vast majority of cases, new logos or lockups for your project, department, institute, or center add complexity to NYU’s visual landscape and are, therefore, unnecessary.



### Logo, Lockup, and Identity Support

For questions concerning all-u logos, lockups, and campaign/initiative identities, please contact Marketing Communications through the [MarComm Service Request Form](#).

# Why NYU Does Not Allow Additional or New Logos or Lockups

- 1

**The NYU logo and its corresponding lockups reflect our strong reputation.**

By using the NYU logo or unit lockup, you tap into a world-renowned brand identity and reputation that has been established over NYU’s nearly 200-year history. Separate or unique logos and lockups often confuse the audience and your message.
- 2

**A coordinated visual identity builds and reinforces the larger NYU brand.**

Seemingly unrelated logos and lockups serve neither the interests of the individual unit nor NYU as a whole. The collective power of a single brand strengthens the name recognition of individual NYU units.
- 3

**The NYU logo’s professional design has endured the test of time.**

Logos that are not designed by professionals can negatively impact an initiative and undermine the University’s reputation. Tom Geismar of Chermayeff & Geismar & Haviv, the renowned branding firm behind some of the world’s leading logos like NBC, Mobil, PBS, and the Smithsonian Institution, designed the NYU logo.
- 4

**Using the NYU logo and lockups makes communications clear.**

The most effective communications are simple. Unfamiliar or multiple logos or lockups add to the complexity of communications and place an extra burden on the audience to decipher the message.
- 5

**NYU has sufficient resources to effectively promote its brand, to the benefit of all units within the University.**

Promoting a brand and its logos and lockups takes considerable financial resources and time. Most initiatives do not have the resources or expertise to effectively brand themselves through widespread advertising and marketing.

# University Seal

Our university seal is not our logo but a more formal representation of the NYU identity. It is used in very select instances.

The university seal, created circa the late 19th century, is composed of five emblems that embrace NYU’s goals and traditions: the NYU name, the institution’s founding year in Roman numerals, the university motto, four runners, and the Statue of Liberty’s upheld torch. The placement of the motto—*perstare et praestare*, to persevere and to excel—under the depiction of classic runners represents the continued pursuit of academic excellence, and Lady Liberty’s torch signifies NYU’s commitment of service to New York City.

The university seal should be used only on official documents such as diplomas and corporate contracts or through licensing agreements maintained at the NYU Bookstore. All additional usages of the university seal should be reviewed by Marketing Communications.

Contact [urpa.styleguide@nyu.edu](mailto:urpa.styleguide@nyu.edu) for the university seal and to request a review.

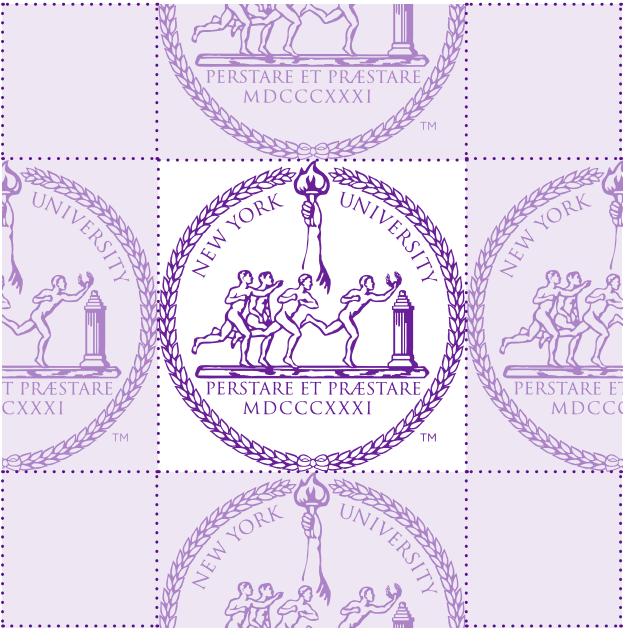
 **Accessibility Note**

Set the **alt text** in communications to “New York University seal, featuring the university motto, *perstare et praestare* (to persevere and to excel) and the founding year, 1831.” If you use the seal as a background element, mark it as decorative (i.e., set the alt text to “Null.”).

## Color Variations



## Clear Space



At least half a seal width of space between the university seal and other elements

## Minimum Size



Our Visual expression

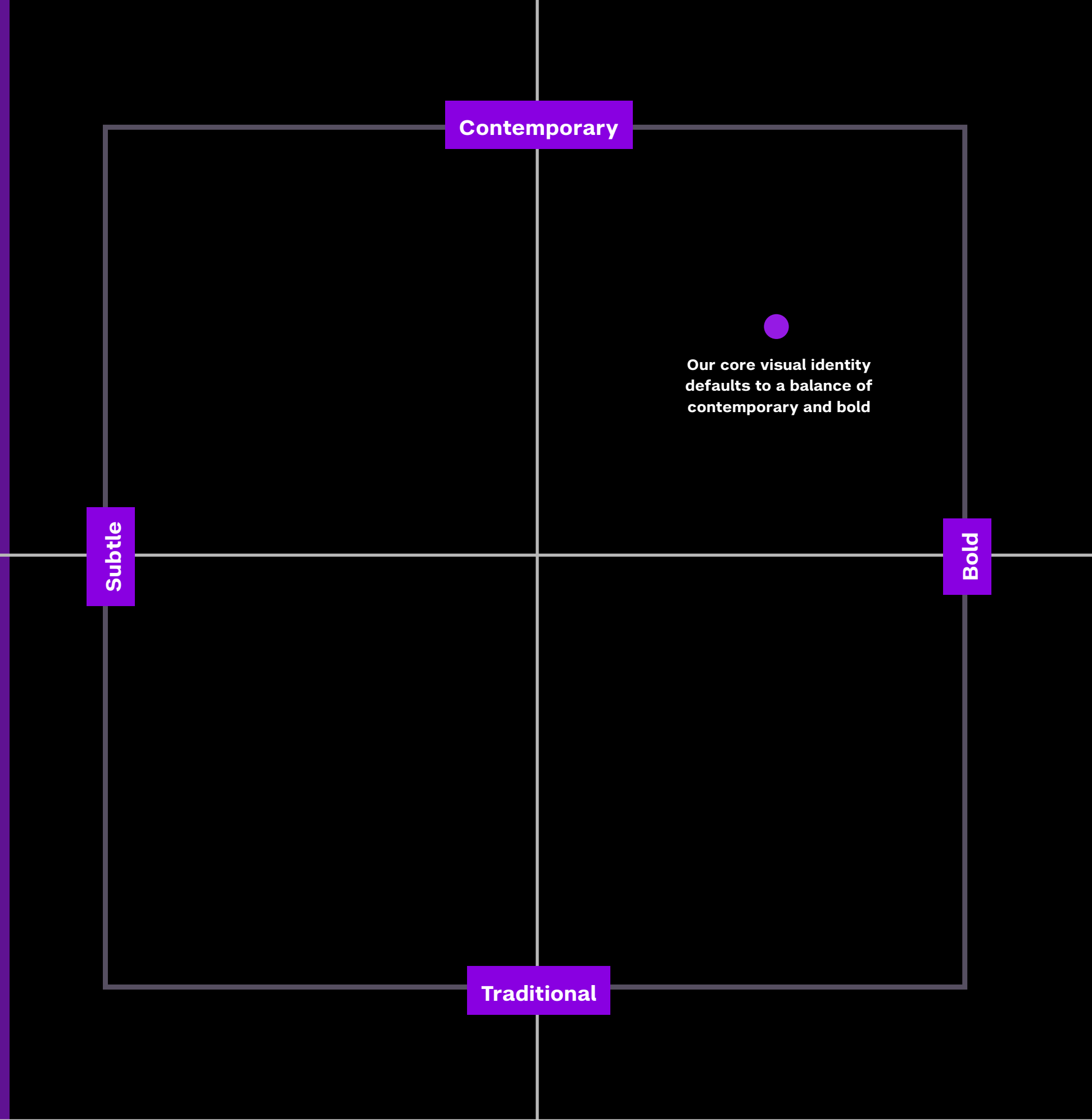
# Visual Tone Spectrum

# Visual Tone Spectrum

Your audience and message should dictate your design decisions. Color, typography, photography, and layout all convey different tones, which is to say different energies and emotions.

To the right, we provided a grid that covers four different visual inflections. A description of each as well as recommendations for color, typography, and graphic usage to help you determine which visual tone works best for your communication are included throughout these guidelines.

The visual tone can range from contemporary to traditional and bold to subtle.

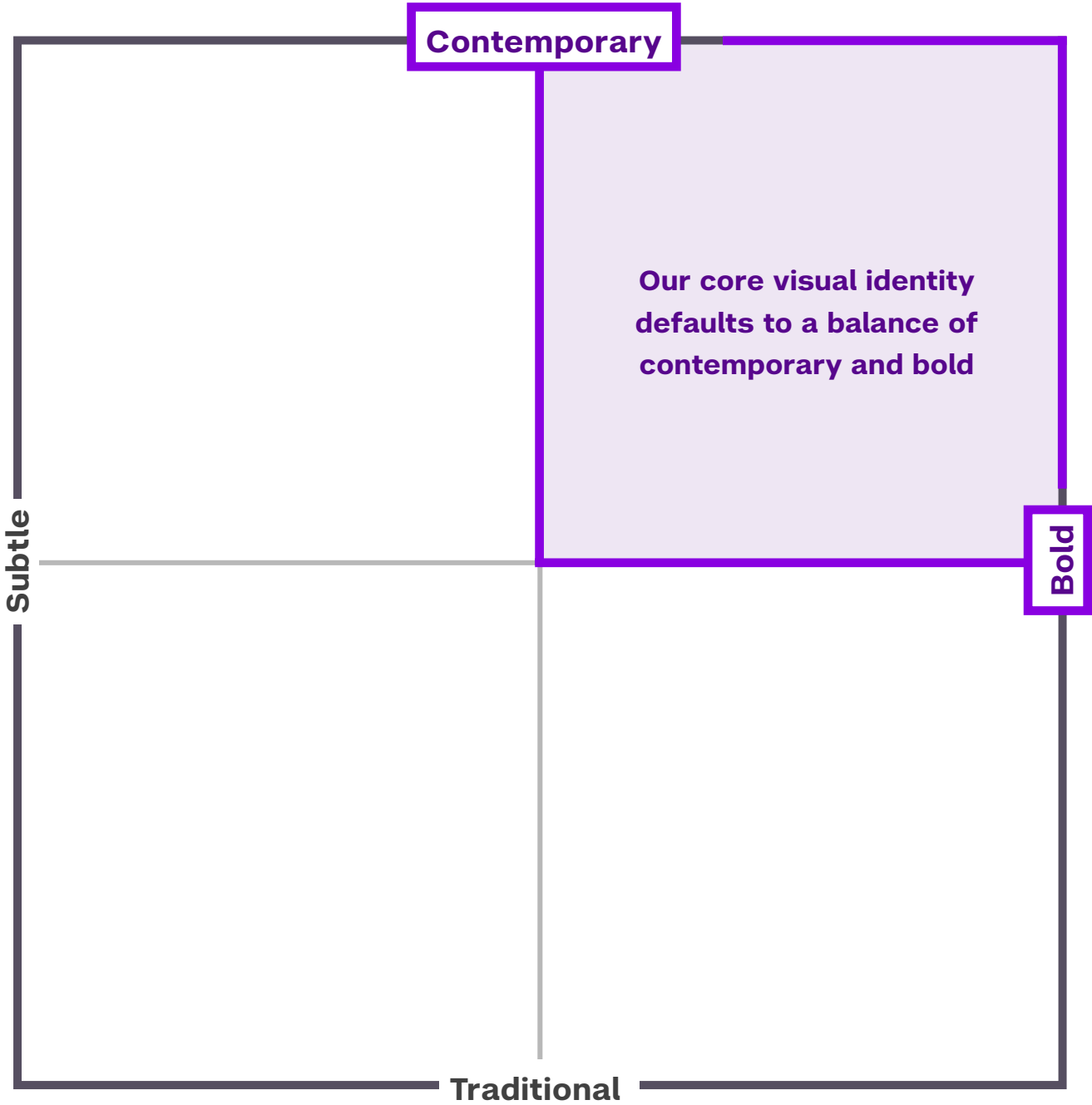


# Contemporary/Bold

This tone captures the excitement and energy of urban life and NYU’s innovative culture. It’s a celebration of creative minds in all fields coming together to inspire one another, explore possibilities, and change the world. This tone is more informal, embracing some of the rougher edges and creativity of the city, and it resonates with younger audiences.

Communications examples include:

- Undergraduate communications
- Central services like financial aid, bursar, and registrar
- Dining, housing, and campus safety

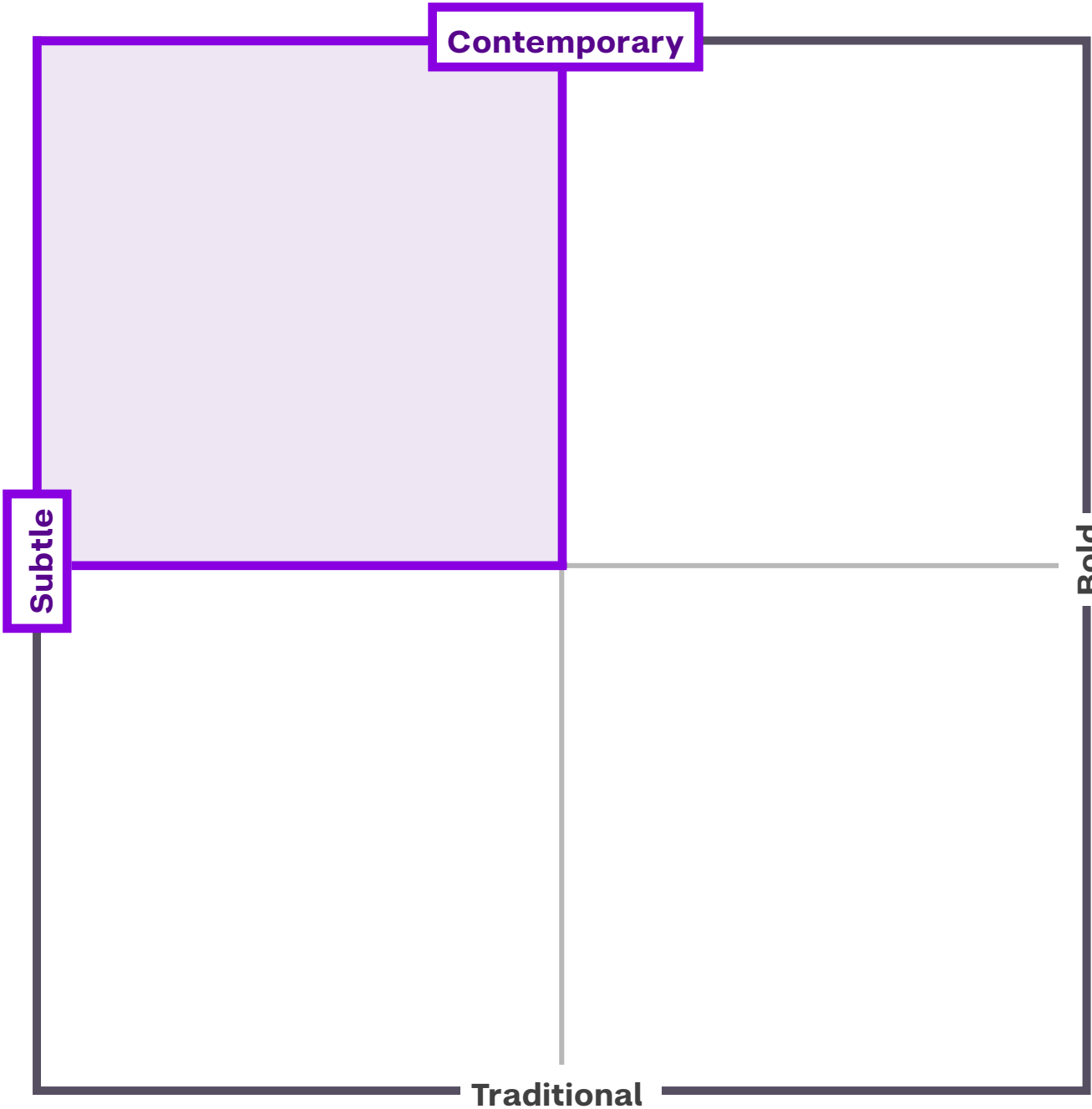


# Contemporary/Subtle

Here, that same energy and excitement are grounded in maturity and confidence. This tone resonates with our audiences who are established in their work at NYU and gain motivation from the knowledge that through it they are working for a better world.

Communications examples include:

- NYU Sustainability Climate Action Plan Update 2021
- Office of Work Life Manager’s Toolkit (refer to page 111)
- Making a Difference Awards



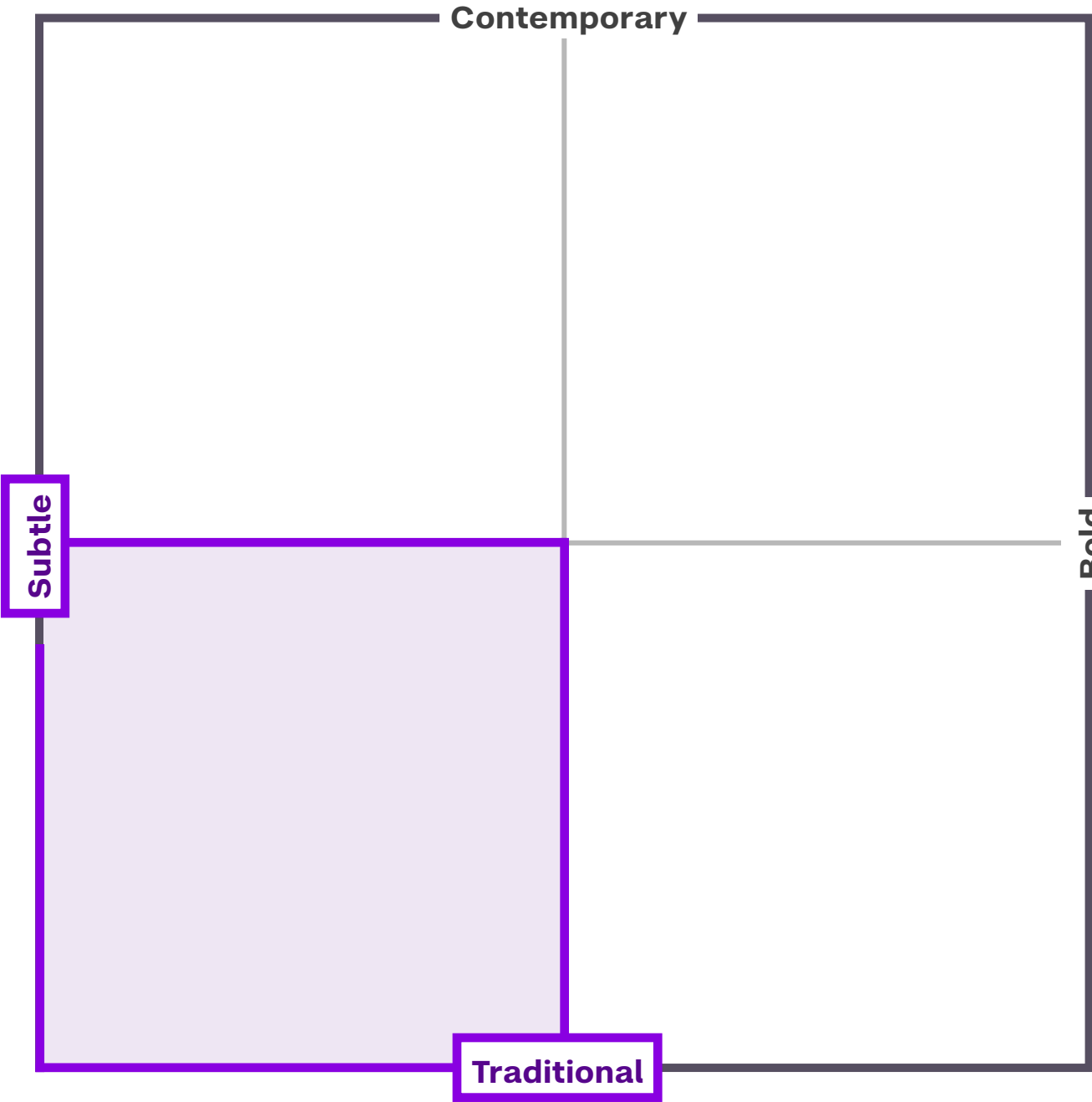


# Traditional/Subtle

This tone is for formal communications that require a personal and accessible touch. It is sophisticated and restrained, and it emphasizes our position as a prestigious academic institution at the center of many industries. It resonates most with nonstudent audiences.

Communications examples include:

- Presidential events
- Commencement invitation
- Faculty Honors Reception

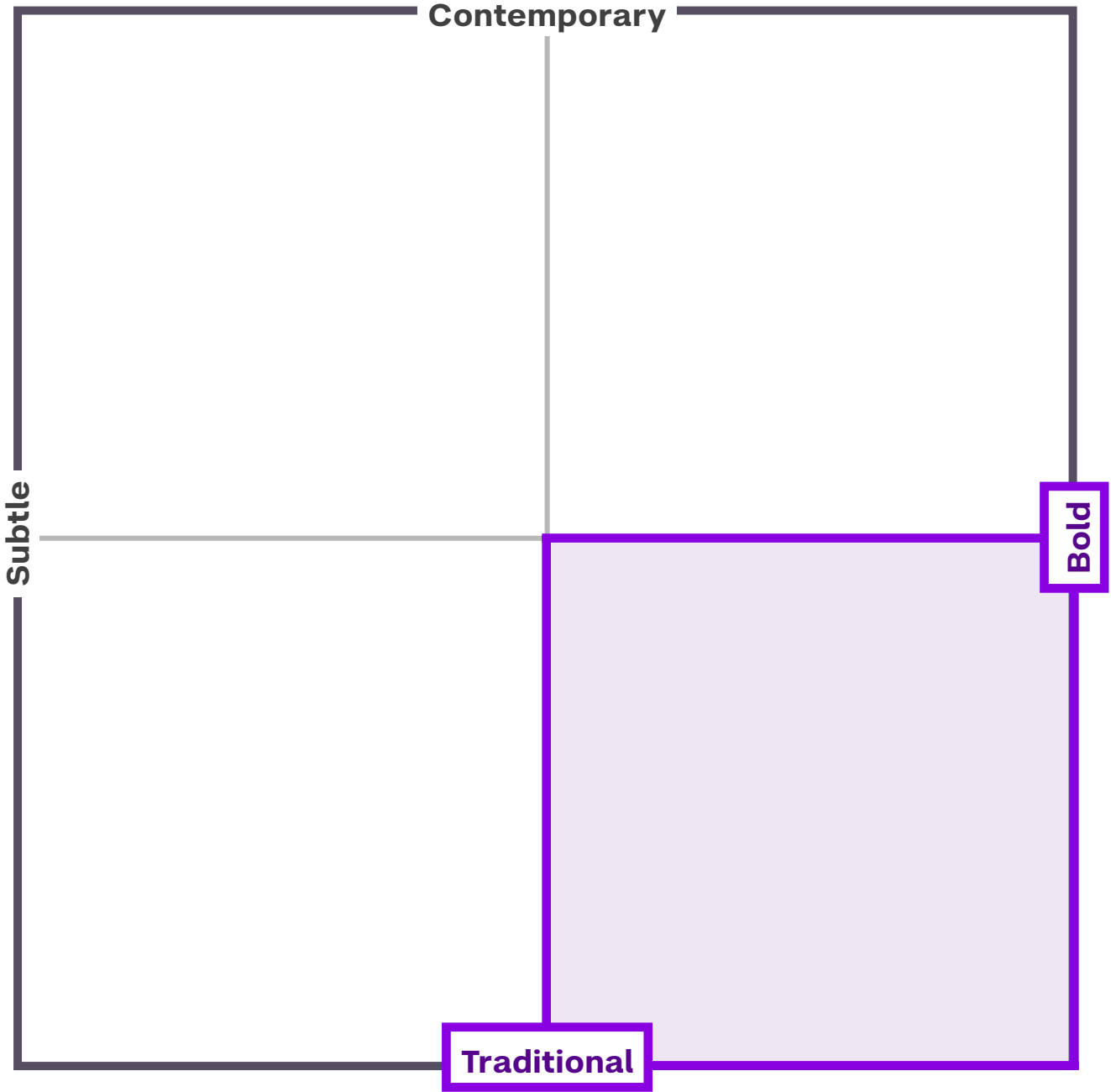


# Traditional/Bold

This tone is for impactful messaging that needs the weight of NYU’s gravitas behind it. It conveys a sense of importance, so consider it for quieter, more classic pieces.

Communications examples include:

- Society of Retired Faculty
- University budget presentation
- Graduate Admissions brochure



OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# Color

# Our Color Palette

Color evokes emotion, which is why it’s such a powerful component of how our audience experiences our brand. Our color palette brings the power and vibrancy of NYU’s urban locations and community to life.

## NYU Violet

This is our principal brand color. It should be used in every communication and design. Violet is a distinctive color that has long been associated with the nonconformist who pushes boundaries to leave their mark on the world.

## Ultra Violet

An electrified version of NYU Violet, this color adds excitement to our communications. Ultra Violet should be used thoughtfully and sparingly to add impact or interest, emphasize important information, increase contrast, or create rhythm within your design.

## Black

A bold color, black strikes the perfect balance between sophistication and edginess when used alongside NYU Violet.

# Primary Colors

**NYU Violet**  
PMS: 2597  
CMYK: C80 M99 Y0 K0  
RGB: R87 G6 B140  
HEX: #57068c

**Ultra Violet**  
PMS: 266 C  
CMYK: N/A\*  
RGB: R137 G0 B225  
HEX: #8900e1

\*Cannot achieve Ultra Violet in print with CMYK; use formula for Medium Violet 2

**Black**  
PMS: Black 6 C  
CMYK: C0 M0 Y0 K100  
RGB: R0 G0 B0  
HEX: #000000

# Secondary Colors

**Deep Violet**  
CMYK: C92 M100 Y23 K28  
RGB: R51 G6 B98  
HEX: #330662

**Medium Violet 1**  
CMYK: C69 M96 Y0 K0  
RGB: R112 G43 B157  
HEX: #702b9d

**Medium Violet 2**  
CMYK: C60 M75 Y0 K0  
RGB: R123 G90 B166  
HEX: #7b5aa6

**Light Violet 1**  
CMYK: C34 M54 Y0 K0  
RGB: R171 G130 B197  
HEX: #ab82c5

**Light Violet 2**  
CMYK: C5 M9 Y0 K0  
RGB: R238 G230 B243  
HEX: #eee6f3

# Neutrals

**Dark Gray**  
CMYK: C68 M61 Y60 K47  
RGB: R64 G64 B64  
HEX: #404040

**Medium Gray 1**  
CMYK: C58 M49 Y49 K16  
RGB: R109 G109 B109  
HEX: #6d6d6d

**Medium Gray 2**  
CMYK: C28 M22 Y23 K0  
RGB: R184 G184 B184  
HEX: #b8b8b8

**Medium Gray 3**  
CMYK: C15 M11 Y12 K0  
RGB: R214 G214 B214  
HEX: #d6d6d6

**Light Gray**  
CMYK: C4 M2 Y2 K0  
RGB: R242 G242 B242  
HEX: #f2f2f2

**White**  
CMYK: C0 M0 Y0 K0  
RGB: R255 G255 B255  
HEX: #ffffff

# Accent Colors

Accent colors can be used for emphasis and contrast within your design. They can highlight important elements of your communication such as infographics, pull quotes, or even a single word in a title.

This selection of colors gives you the option of adding variety to your content while working alongside NYU's primary palette. **Accent colors are not required, but if you want to use one, choose only one and use it sparingly.**



**Teal**  
CMYK: C82 M16 Y54 K01  
RGB: R000 G156 B139  
HEX: #009b8a



**Magenta**  
CMYK: C06 M100 Y19 K00  
RGB: R224 G015 B120  
HEX: #fb0f78



**Blue**  
CMYK: C62 M13 Y11 K00  
RGB: R89 G178 B21209  
HEX: #59B2D1



**Yellow**  
CMYK: C07 M00 Y81 K00  
RGB: R244 G236 B081  
HEX: #f4ec51

Use “deep” values of these accent colors for **text on white backgrounds** to ensure proper contrast. **Do not** use these colors for text on black or violet.



**Deep Teal**  
CMYK: C86 M29 Y54 K08  
RGB: R000 G131 B124  
HEX: #00837C



**Deep Magenta**  
CMYK: C06 M100 Y19 K00  
RGB: R224 G015 B120  
HEX: #e00f78



**Deep Blue**  
CMYK: C54 M00 Y15 K00  
RGB: R105 G202 B217  
HEX: #4E7AA1

 **Accessibility Note**

Check your color contrast levels with the [Colour Contrast Analyzer](#). Refer to page 67 for more information on accessible color usage.



**Custom Accent Palettes**

Fill out the [MarComm Service Request Form](#) for help creating a custom accent palette for your unit or initiative.



# Using Color Palette Ratios

The color palettes here are suggestions of how to flex the NYU colors to best suit the tone of your communication. Not every color in each palette has to be used, but NYU Violet should be present in every version of the palette to further emphasize the NYU brand.

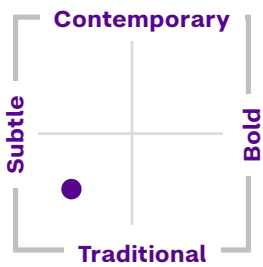
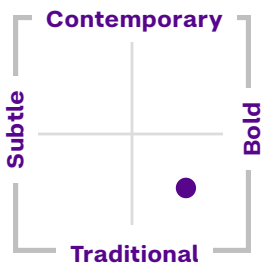
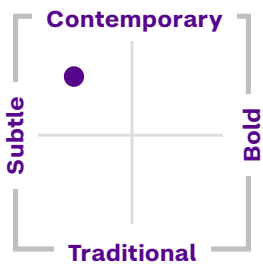
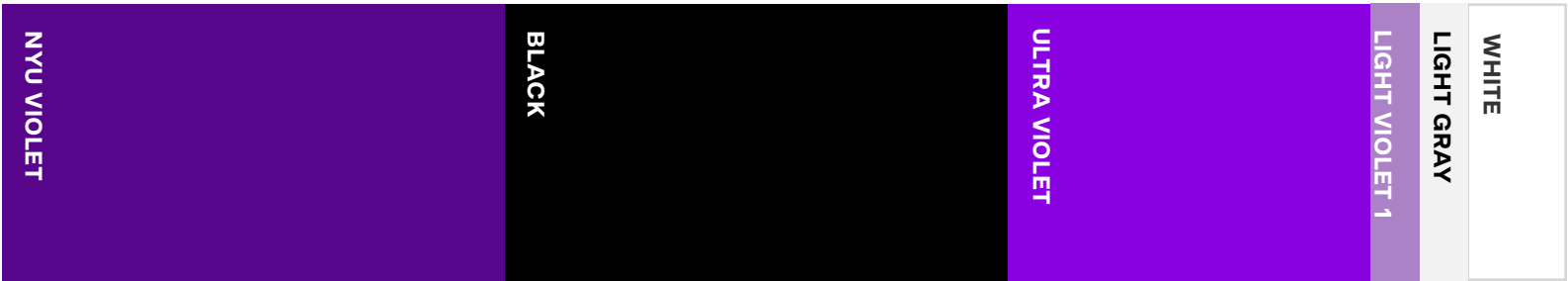
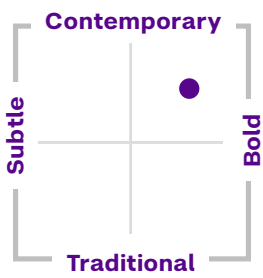
These breakdowns are not exact percentages, but they provide an idea of relative use. For example, a traditional/subtle design could incorporate more NYU Violet than a contemporary/subtle design; a contemporary/bold design could incorporate more black than a contemporary/subtle design. (Refer to pages 53 to 57 for more detailed visual tone spectrum descriptions.)

**Note:** With the exception of headlines, set typography primarily in black or dark gray. In digital applications, set the body text to #333333 or #404040 to reduce the eye strain caused by very high contrast.

 **Accessibility Note**

Reserve shades of violet and neutrals for background colors and decorative graphic elements. According to the World Wide Web Consortium, if icons are required to understand content, then they must have a contrast ratio of at least 3-to-1. Check your contrast levels with the [Colour Contrast Analyser](#).

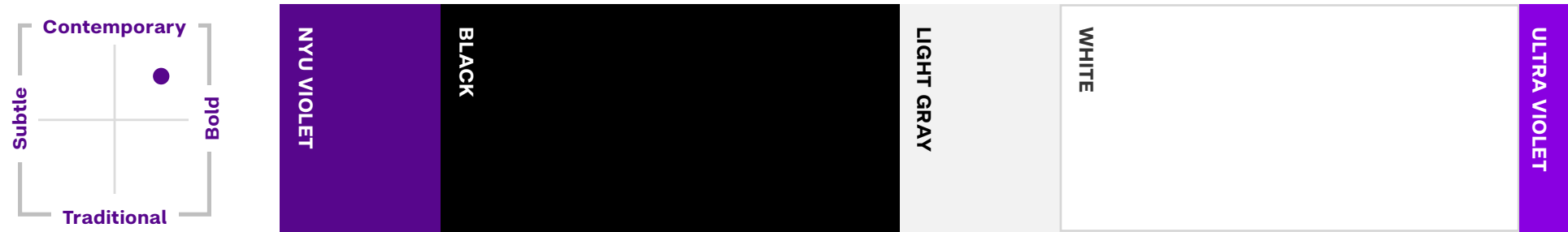
**Note:** The contemporary/bold palette should be used in general marketing materials.



# Using Color Palette Ratios

Here is an example of how to envision the color palette ratios on page 62. Colors that are more prominent within a composition are allotted larger percentages within the ratios.

## Contemporary/Bold Palette Example



In this example, the color palette ratio is applied in the following ways:



**NYU Violet** is used for the NYU logo and parts of the city grid graphics.



**Black** is used as a background color.



**Light gray** is used for parts of the city grid graphics.



**White** is used to give the viewer's eye a rest on the right side of the design.



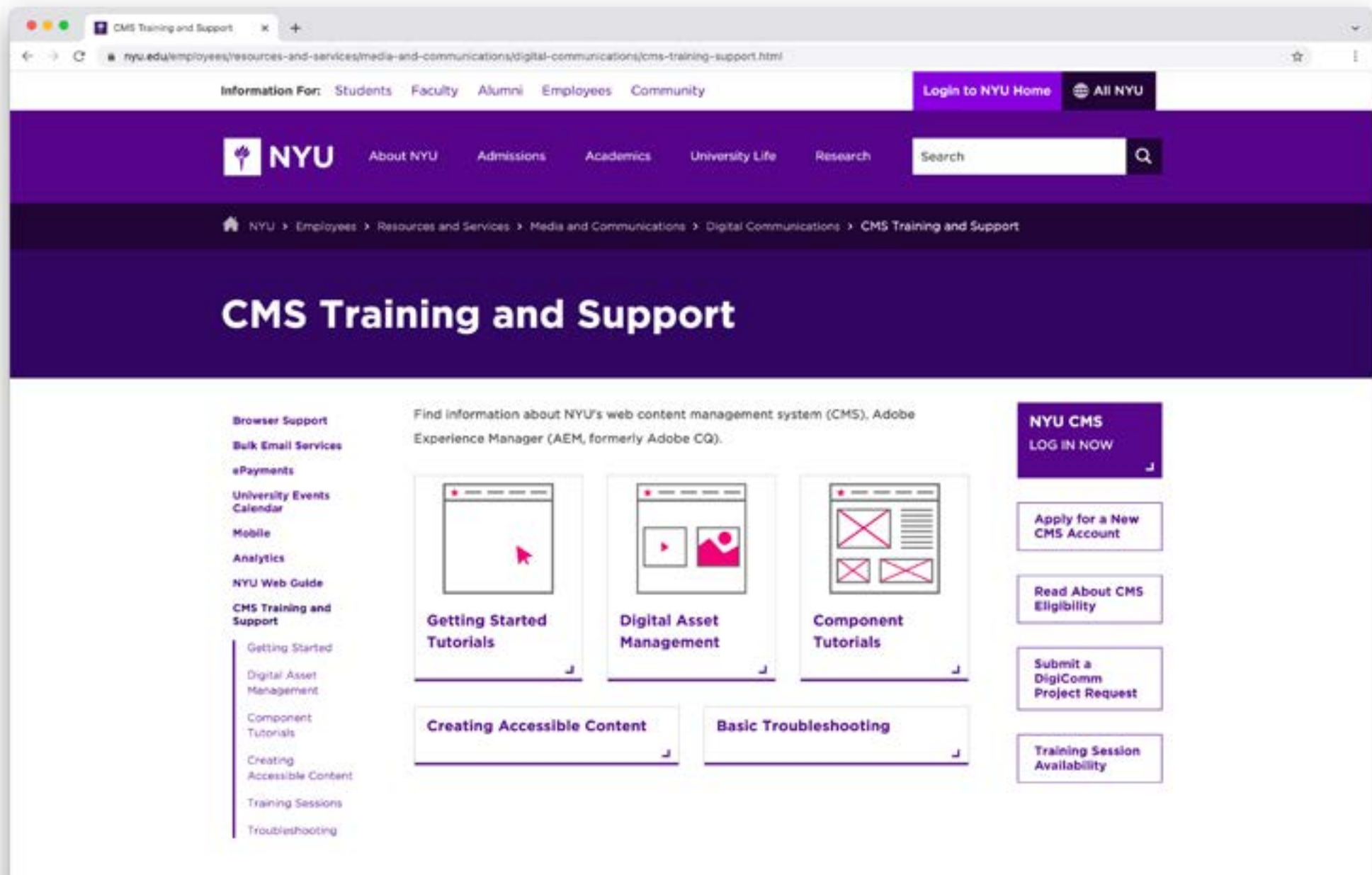
**Ultra Violet** is used sparingly within the banner text and the path that weaves through the design.

# Using Color

## Accent Colors

Accent colors should be used selectively to support our primary, secondary, and neutral colors.

**Web Example** In this example, magenta is used on a web page to add vibrancy to the iconography.



### Custom Accent Palettes

Fill out the [MarComm Service Request Form](#) for help creating a custom accent palette for your unit or initiative.



# Using Color

## Accent Colors

Accent colors should be used selectively to support our primary, secondary, and neutral colors.

**Print Example** In this example, yellow is used as a visual anchor in both the dropped capital and pull quote.



### Custom Accent Palettes

Fill out the [MarComm Service Request Form](#) for help creating a custom accent palette for your unit or initiative.

# Using Color

## Working with Color Formulations

To the right, we provided recommendations for using the full NYU color palette and color formulations in specific types of communications.

### Print

**Cyan, magenta, yellow, black (CMYK)** is the standard formula used in printing. But there can be color variations depending on the printing method and type of paper and finishes used. Always check the printer’s proofs to make sure the color appears as intended before printing.

**Pantone Matching System (PMS)** colors produce more consistent color across the board but can be costly. If you can only choose one or two PMS colors, then choose NYU Violet and/or Ultra Violet.

### Digital

**Red, green, blue (RGB)** is a color gamut of light using red, green, and blue to render colors on-screen.

**Hexadecimal (HEX)** is also used on-screen and is basically a short code for RGB color. A HEX color is a six-digit combination of letters and numbers.

**Note:** The appearance of colors can vary digitally from monitor to monitor and in print from paper stock to paper stock.

# Accessibility: Color Contrast

Check the color contrast between your foreground and background colors to ensure your message is legible.

Determine the contrast ratio of text and background color combinations in your designs using a color contrast checking tool such as the [Colour Contrast Analyzer](#).

Contrast Ratios

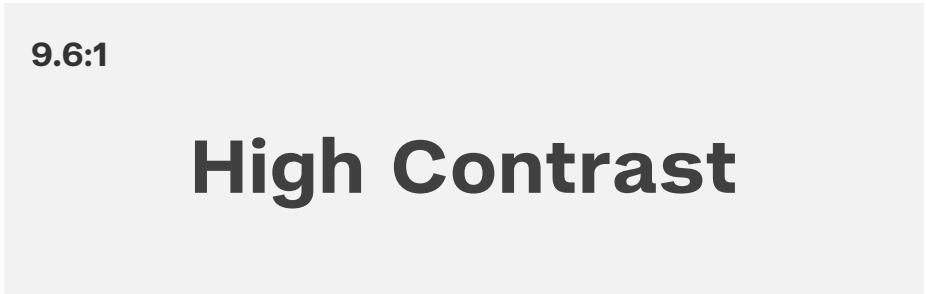
- Regular text: **4.5:1**
- Large text (i.e., ≥ 18 pt font or ≥ 14 pt bold): **3:1**
- Icons/Graphical elements: **3:1**

✓ **Examples of Approved Color Pairings**

The following combinations pass accessibility standards. These color pairings create enough contrast for the reader.



 **Text** #ffffff       **Background** #57068c



 **Text** #404040       **Background** #f2f2f2



 **Text** #ffffff       **Background** #8900e1

✗ **Examples of Color Pairings to Avoid**

The following combinations **DO NOT** pass accessibility standards. These colors **DO NOT** create enough contrast for the reader.



 **Text** #8900e1       **Background** #57068c



 **Text** #57068c       **Background** #000000



 **Text** #57068c       **Background** #8900e1

OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# Typography



# Our Typography Style

NYU’s typographic language brings your communication to life. Like color, the fonts we use reinforce the tone of our communications and designs. NYU Perstare is our primary typeface.

This versatile font family can be combined with recommended secondary typefaces to achieve different tones. That flexibility helps our communications appeal to many of our different audiences, including students, parents, alumni, faculty and staff, peers, and supporters, while maintaining a thematically consistent brand. (Refer to pages 76 and 77 for more information on setting tone with type.)

Font choice also establishes a clear hierarchy of information, allowing audiences to easily navigate your communications.



# NYU Perstare

Drawing on the energy of human connections and NYU’s urban heart, NYU Perstare represents all that the University encompasses through its bold, strong presence paired with organic flourishes. Its name, drawn from our motto, “Perstare et Praestare” (to persevere and to excel) is a nod to the NYU spirit of persistence and ingenuity that has been foundational to our continued excellence.

# Our Typeface:

## NYU Perstare

NYU’s primary typeface, NYU Perstare, is available in a range of weights and styles, lending it versatility and adaptability to a range of messaging needs.

Use NYU Perstare for all kinds of communications. Take advantage of the wide variety of weights to create clear type hierarchies across a range of visual tones, whether your content is a simple flyer or a complex report.

**Note:** For the foreseeable future, the NYU logo and lockups will remain in the Gotham typeface, but any other messaging should use NYU Perstare whenever possible.



### Get NYU Perstare

[Download the desktop version of NYU Perstare](#) (NYU NetID required).

To access the web version of NYU Perstare, email [digitalcommunications@nyu.edu](mailto:digitalcommunications@nyu.edu) with context for your request.

# NYU Perstare

### Glyphs

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk  
Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv  
Ww Xx Yy Zz 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0  
& @ # \$ % ? ! ; , .



### Weights

Thin  
Light

*Thin Italic*  
*Light Italic*

Regular  
Medium  
Bold  
Black  
Ultra

*Italic*  
*Medium Italic*  
*Bold Italic*  
*Black Italic*  
*Ultra Italic*

### Notes

Only use **thin** and **light** weights for larger text. These weights are not accessible at smaller sizes and should never be used as body text (i.e., 16 pt or smaller).

# NYU Perstare

## Alternatives

In some situations, our brand typeface is not available. So we selected three backup options to maintain the integrity of our visual identity.

These sophisticated serif typefaces lend a softer or more traditional tone to communications. Use them for body copy or accent text such as pull quotes, lead-ins, and subheads. NYU Perstare is our main brand typeface, so these should play a supporting role in type combinations across our visual expression.

### For Google Workspace

# Montserrat

#### About

Montserrat is our free alternative for NYU Perstare.

It is available to download on Google Fonts and can be used in the Google Workspace.

#### Glyphs

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0 & @ # \$ % ' & ; , .

#### Weights

|                  |                                |
|------------------|--------------------------------|
| Light            | <i>Light Italic</i>            |
| Regular          | <i>Regular Italic</i>          |
| Medium           | <i>Medium Italic</i>           |
| <b>SemiBold</b>  | <b><i>SemiBold Italic</i></b>  |
| <b>Bold</b>      | <b><i>Bold Italic</i></b>      |
| <b>ExtraBold</b> | <b><i>ExtraBold Italic</i></b> |
| <b>Black</b>     | <b><i>Black Italic</i></b>     |

#### Download

[Download Montserrat](#)

### For Email and Microsoft 365

# Helvetica

Helvetica is our first system font alternative for NYU Perstare. It is widely available on both Windows and Mac operating systems and can be used when NYU Perstare and Montserrat are not available.

# Arial

Arial is our second system font alternative for NYU Perstare. It is always available on both Windows and Mac operating systems and can be used when NYU Perstare, Montserrat, and Helvetica are not available.

# Secondary Typeface Recommendations:

In the event that you want to use a secondary, serif typeface that works well with NYU Perstare, we have selected three options that are free and easily accessible.

## For Google Workspace

# Frank Ruhl Libre

### About

Frank Ruhl Libre is available to download on Google Fonts and can be used in the Google Workspace.

### Glyphs

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk  
Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu  
Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 0  
& @ # \$ % ? ! ; , .

### Weights

|              |                     |
|--------------|---------------------|
| Light        | <i>Light</i>        |
| Regular      | <i>Regular</i>      |
| Medium       | <i>Medium</i>       |
| Bold         | <i>Bold</i>         |
| <b>Black</b> | <b><i>Black</i></b> |

### Design Note

True italics are not available for free download. In Adobe Creative Cloud, skew text to 14 degrees to achieve false italics.

### Download

 [Download Frank Ruhl Libre](#)

## For Email and Microsoft 365

# Georgia

Georgia is a system font alternative. It is widely available on both Windows and Mac operating systems and can be used when Frank Ruhl Libre is not available.

# Times New Roman

Times New Roman is a second system font alternative. It is widely available on both Windows and Mac operating systems and can be used when Frank Ruhl Libre and Georgia are not available.

# Using Type

## Line Spacing (Leading)

Line spacing, called leading, is critical to setting professional-looking type that is easy to read. Leading should be set tight, but not too tight.

✖ 19 pt type | 38 pt leading

Loose leading can disrupt a layout and cause too much pause between lines.

✖ 19 pt type | 15 pt leading

Tight leading can cause strain on the eyes and disrupt the letterforms.

✔ 19 pt type | 20 pt leading

Correct leading allows for a balanced paragraph and increases legibility.

**Design Note**

Keep legibility in mind when setting the leading. Setting the leading value to 2 pt above the text size is a great starting point, then you can adjust it accordingly. Generally, leading for smaller text like body copy will be greater than that of larger text like headers.

## Letter Spacing (Tracking)

Correct letter spacing, called tracking, makes type easy to read. Tracking that is too loose or too tight disrupts the flow of text and strains the eyes.

Correct tracking allows for a balanced paragraph and increases legibility. Generally, ideal tracking falls somewhere between -10 pt and 10 pt.

### Tracking for NYU Perstare

✖ +100 Tracking  
Loose tracking disrupts the flow of text.

✖ -100 Tracking  
Tight tracking disrupts the flow of text.

✔ -10 Tracking  
Correct tracking allows for a balanced paragraph.

**Design Note**

Ideal tracking can vary based on the default tracking of the typeface you are using, text size, and casing. Generally, default to tighter tracking for larger text and looser tracking for all-caps text.

### Tracking for Frank Ruhl Libre

✖ +100 Tracking  
Loose tracking disrupts the flow of text.

✖ -100 Tracking  
Tight tracking disrupts the flow of text.

✔ 0 Tracking  
Correct tracking allows for a balanced paragraph.



# Accessibility: Typographic Hierarchy

It is important to properly nest typography headings in print and digital design. Headings make your content easy to scan. For sighted users, headings create visual order. Screen-reader and assistive technology users rely on headings to navigate websites and digital applications.

Headings are ranked H1 through H6 and must be used in order. H1 represents the most important idea on a page or screen. An H1 can only be used once. H2 through H6 represent subsections. Remember not to skip levels when creating subsections. For example, you can go from H2 to H3, but cannot skip from H2 to H4.

To learn more about creating accessible headings online, refer to Digital Communication’s [Common Accessibility Mistakes](#) web page.

Information For: Students Faculty Alumni Employees Community

Login to NYU Home All NYU

NYU

About NYU Admissions Academics University Life Research

Search

NYU Employees Resources and Services Media and Communications Digital Communications CMS Training and Support Training Test

## Training Test

Content Template with Sidebar

Content Template

Training Test

### Lorem Ipsum

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas augue tortor, tempus a facilisis sed, faucibus nec ligula. Vivamus id elit eu nisi lacinia dapibus eu vel felis. Duis malesuada varius consectetur. Curabitur pharetra dignissim ligula vitae suscipit. Nunc luctus sed mi vel condimentum.

### Pellentesque Odio Nisi

Curabitur vestibulum finibus luctus. Phasellus quis ex quis enim pulvinar ultrices. Pellentesque feugiat magna sit amet consectetur rhoncus. Pellentesque odio nisi, molestie vitae ex ac, ultrices tempus mauris. Nunc sem ante, faucibus et libero sed, pharetra pellentesque libero. Nullam ac ipsum sed massa aliquam ultricies. Phasellus pharetra blandit nulla, vitae mollis tellus volutpat et.

### Nullam Laoreet Ex Ac

Nullam laoreet ex acNunc venenatis eget enim nec tincidunt. Duis malesuada enim sem, sed sodales diam convallis id. Nullam laoreet ex ac finibus consequat. Suspendisse leo mauris, aliquam a ante vel, tempor placerat nisi. Donec sollicitudin elit sit amet neque mollis scelerisque. Nam sollicitudin neque magna, eu varius augue convallis at. Fusce id placerat nibh, in placerat ante. Proin fringilla ex velit, id efficitur leo viverra non. Suspendisse a tempus felis, in porttitor nulla. Vestibulum ante ipsum primis in faucibus orci luctus et ultrices posuere cubilia Curae; Suspendisse varius augue ornare, lacinia libero ac, ultrices metus.

### Mauris Id Ligula Elit

Nunc gravida elit eu dapibus fermentum. Mauris id ligula elit. Nullam tempus quam et elementum metus. Nulla eu consequat mi.

### Quisque Aliquet

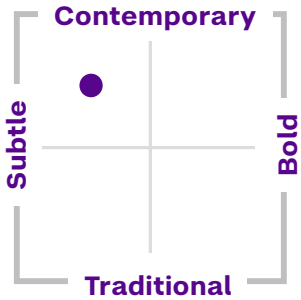
Curabitur eleifend laoreet justo nec faucibus. Sed at semper magna, eu commodo massa. Quisque aliquet, felis id sodales egestas, erat dui faucibus risus, pretium lacus arcu tortor ut lacus. Suspendisse pellentesque orci lorem, a egestas nulla aliquam ac. Phasellus suscipit cursus velit quis lacinia. In hac habitasse platea dictumst. Donec et libero pharetra, tempor felis ac, viverra est. Integer sed odio rutrum, malesuada orci ut, elementum metus. Nulla eu consequat mi.

# Setting Visual Tone with Type

## Contemporary

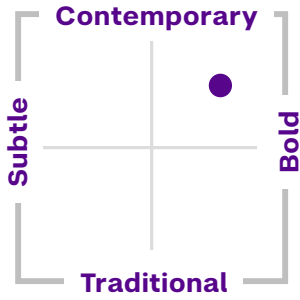
Leverage NYU Perstare’s many different weights to create contemporary type hierarchies.

NYU Perstare is a versatile typeface that can be used in a spectrum of ways ranging from subtle to bold and contemporary to traditional. Heavier weights of NYU Perstare (like bold, black, and ultra) can generally be used in headers to make your communications feel bolder; lighter weights (like thin, light, regular, and medium) can be used to make your communications feel more subtle. Always set body text in NYU Perstare Regular for optimal legibility.



### Contemporary/Subtle

Use lighter weights of NYU Perstare in communications to maintain that contemporary edge.



### Contemporary/Bold

For bolder communications, use heavier weights of NYU Perstare for headlines and set them in all caps.



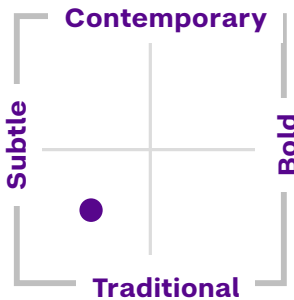
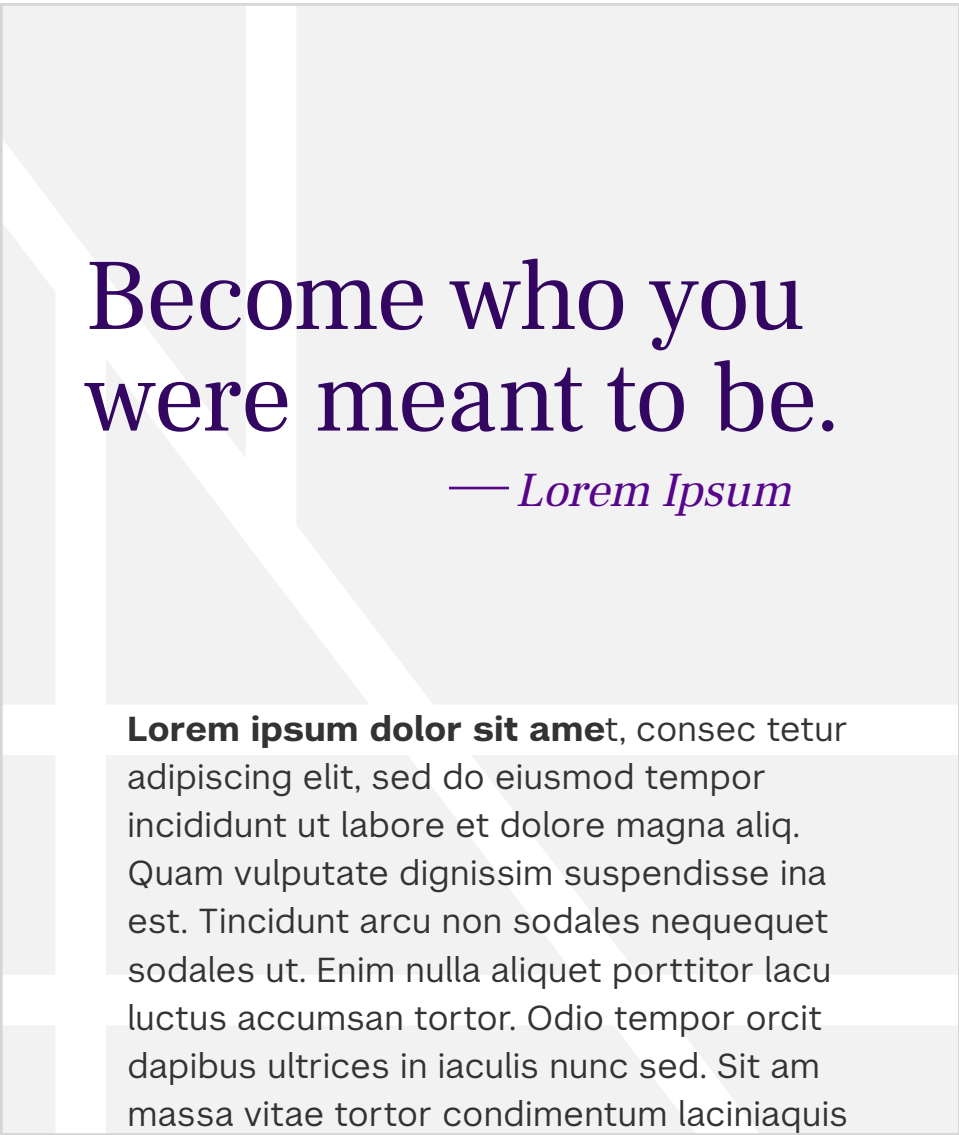
# Setting Visual Tone with Type

## Traditional

Use a combination of NYU Perstare and one of our serif recommendations to make your communications feel more traditional.

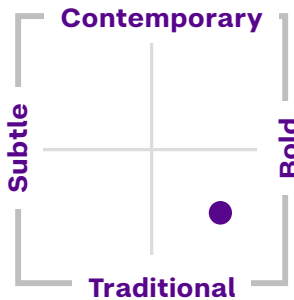
Since NYU Perstare is our primary typeface, it should always be present in our communications. Avoid setting entire communications in serif fonts only, as this starts to feel a bit too traditional and runs the risk of being off-brand.

In general, consider the typographical balance between your headers and body text: if you set your headers in a serif typeface, use NYU Perstare for body text; if you set your headers in NYU Perstare, use a serif font for body text.



### Traditional/Subtle

Combine NYU Perstare and a serif font for a more traditional visual tone. In subtler communications, lighter weights of NYU Perstare can be used as headlines.



### Traditional/Bold

Use a combination of heavier NYU Perstare weights and serif accents to make communications feel bold and traditional.

OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# Graphics

# A GRAPHIC SYSTEM BUILT FROM OUR URBAN SPIRIT.

The New York University city grid graphics were created to show how deeply grounded NYU is in the cities in which it resides. City streets are a representation of our urban spirit, and they are also a metaphor for the exploration, intersection, and movement of people and ideas at NYU.

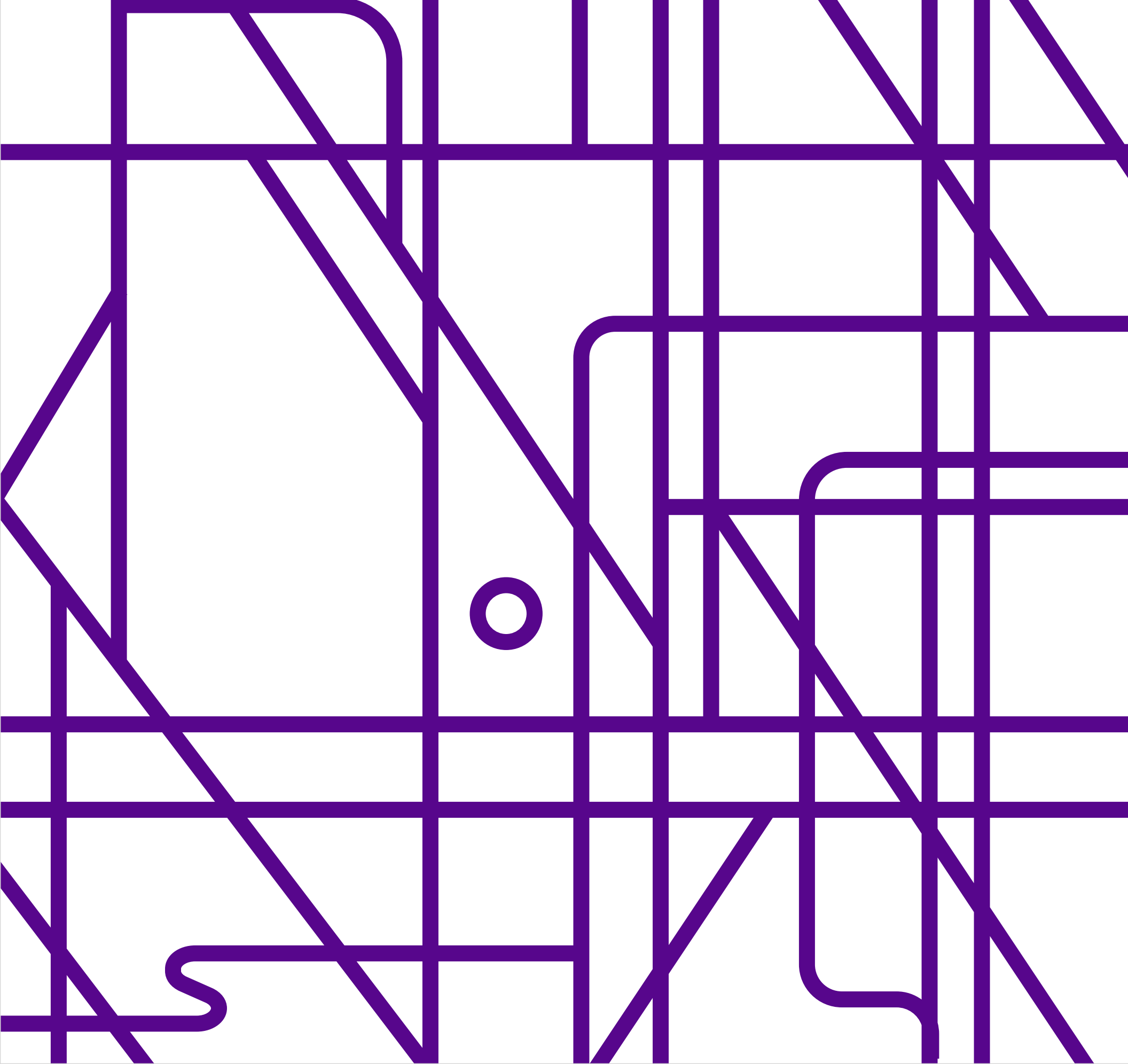




# City Grid Graphics

This grid is the underlying framework for the graphic design of your content. You can break it down into smaller graphic elements, which can be layered within your content in multiple ways.

Using the city grid graphics, which represent New York City and the additional dynamic cities around the world where we are located, will infuse any communication with new and original visual points of view.



## City Grid Graphics Kit

Download the City Grid Graphics Kit  
from [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).

# Graphic System Overview

At NYU, we are ready to explore the intersections where ideas and people meet. And in the city, small interactions can be just as important as the larger sense of community.

That is why paths within the city grid graphics can be pulled out or broken down to emphasize these micro and macro levels of connection and collaboration that make up the NYU experience. Here, we provide examples of how to use the many graphic styles available within the city grid.

Although we’ve mostly focused on the grid itself, it’s important to consider the space around it as well. Use negative space to help set the pace of your communication while drawing the audience’s attention to important information. Instead of interpreting negative space as something to fill, try viewing it as a tool to guide your audience through the communication.



## City Grid Design Templates

Download our professionally designed templates from [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).

### Personal (Individual) p. 82

We’re ready to find something new around every street corner. The single solid line represents our unique journeys.

### Community (City) p. 83

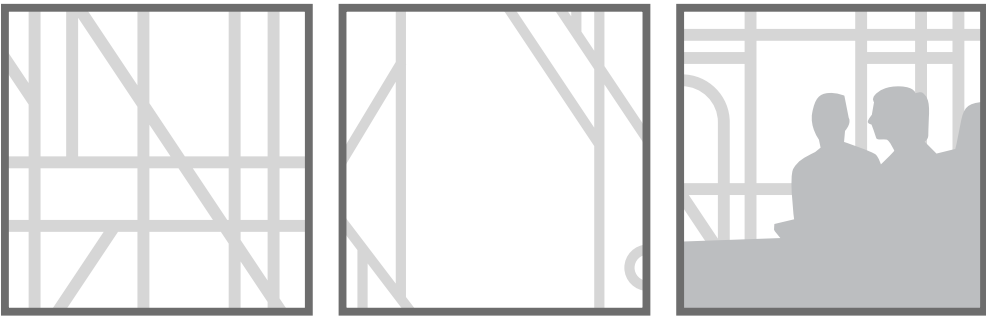
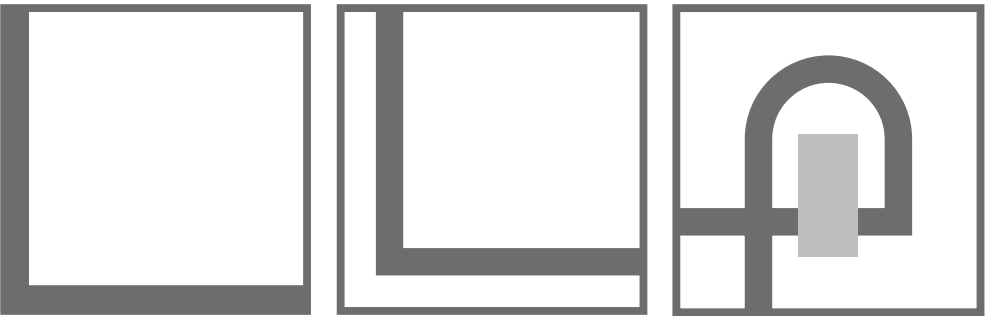
The city grid represents both the urban centers where our campuses are located and the city within our minds that is a playground for our curiosity and inspiration. The solid city grid firmly embraces our roots in these cities.

### Network (Global) p. 84

At NYU, our connections extend past the city streets themselves. We are globally connected to a network of thought leaders, all working to make a difference. The outlined city grid nods to our roots while transcending them to let the content shine.

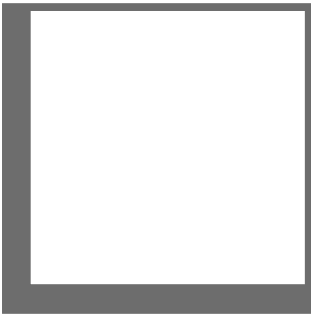
**Simple** ————— **Intermediate** —————> **Complex**

Basic designs layered on top of or behind most content      Designs slightly more integrated with other content      Designs highly integrated with other content



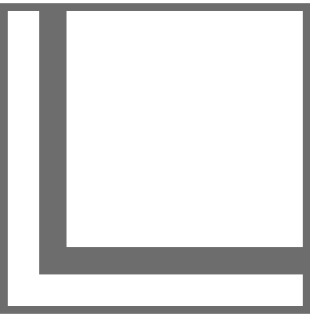
# Graphic System

Personal (Individual)



## Include an open-frame border

The border can sit in any corner of the composition but should not connect to create a complete border.



## Create a lead-through to important content

Lines can be straight or take turns, depending on what you want to highlight. You can place lines at 90 or 56.5 degrees.



## Weave a line through imagery to create depth

The line can accent shapes within the composition and does not need to be in the shape of an arch as demonstrated here.



# Graphic System

## Community (City)



### Use the city grid as a background, frame, or stand-alone graphic

Make sure to only use our brand color palette when approaching it this way. Refer to pages 85 and 86 for tips on how to incorporate typography.



### Pull out a path from the city grid to contain imagery or text

Make sure the line goes from one side of the composition to the other and is anchored to one side of the frame. Avoid creating floating “cutout” shapes.



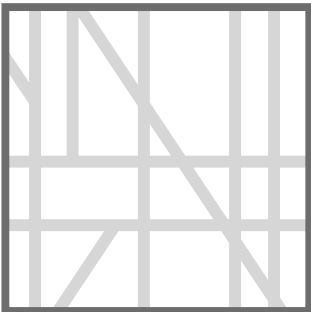
### Overlap certain paths within the city grid with other on-page elements

This approach can help you create depth in your designs. Make sure the overlaying paths go all the way across the composition, instead of stopping midway through.



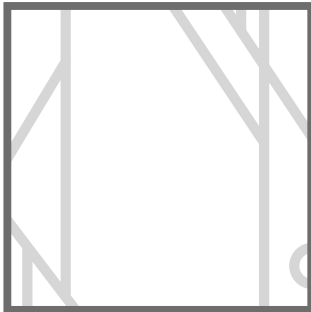
# Graphic System

## Network (Global)



**Use the city grid as an overlay on images at 50 percent opacity to add texture**

Make sure there is enough contrast between the graphic and underlying image so the treatment is apparent.



**Use parts of the city grid to create borders for content**

Delete any unnecessary lines to add extra room for content and make the border less complex. Refer to page 88 for tips on cropping and scale.



**Use parts of the city grid layered within images to create depth and texture**

Mask the foreground of an image on top of the grid.



# Using Graphics

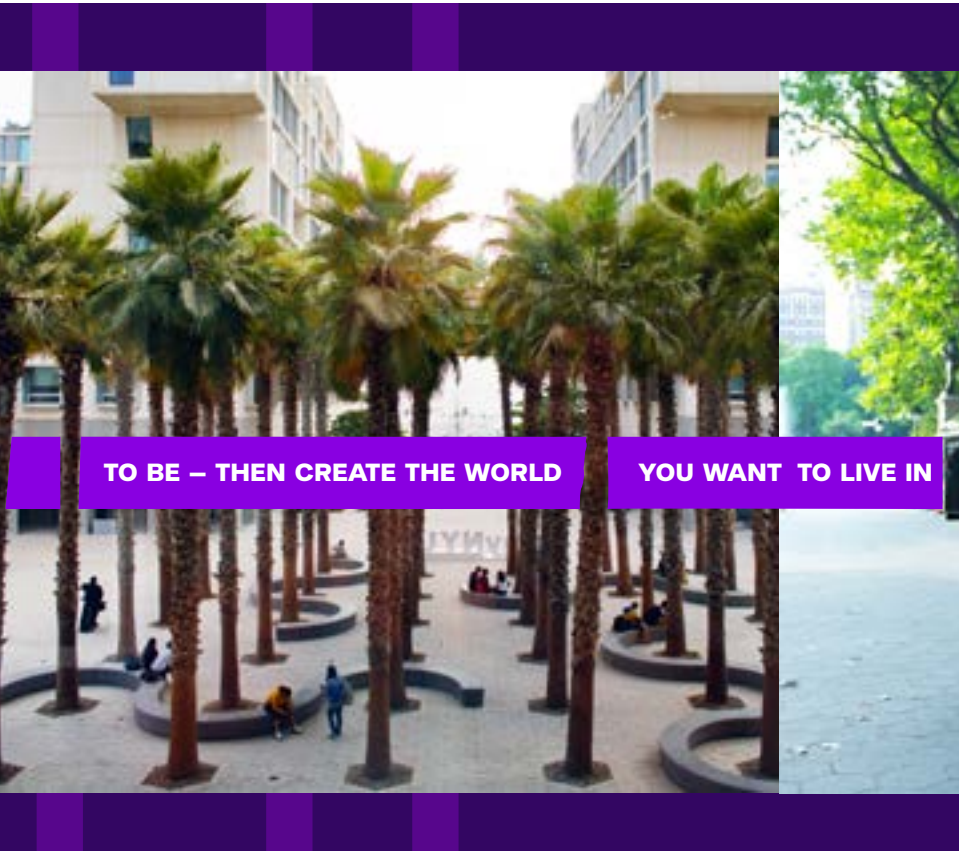
## Paths and Typography

As a graphic element, the path represents where we are today and where we hope to go next. These are the paths that lead us to unexpected intersections of new ideas and opportunities. Below are examples of how to incorporate paths in your communication.



### An extension of the thought

The path can help bridge two ideas or extend a single thought across your layout. This approach makes for a more engaging design without losing the legibility of your message.



### Text box

The path can act as a background for brief but important bits of information. It can help copy stand out on top of photography or visually tie several photographs together with a single message.



### Along the path

The path can act as a visual guide for the reader's eye, helping them follow a narrative through the layout.

# Using Graphics

## City Grid and Typography

The city grid is a versatile tool that elevates your designs and brings a wide range of flexibility to your communications. Below are examples of how the city grid can enhance your content.

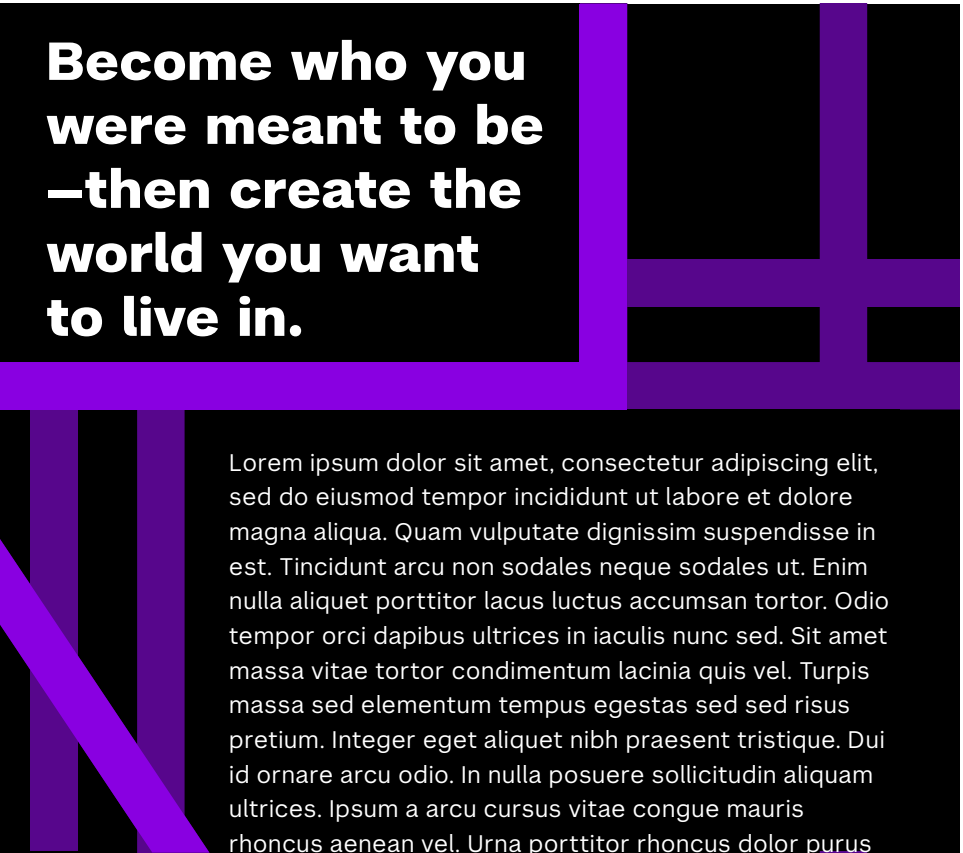


### As a background

The city grid can help ground your copy and photography as a background. It adds texture and movement to a layout without overpowering your content.

 **Accessibility Note**

When layering text over the graphic, make sure the graphic is lighter in color and less complicated so it doesn't interfere with the legibility of the type. Ensure all text passes color contrast requirements (refer to page 67 for more information on color contrast).



### Nestled in negative space

The city grid can also frame your content. You can easily organize your layout by placing copy or photography within the negative spaces of the grid.



### Woven within text

You can add depth and energy to your communications by weaving headlines through the city grid. Be sure that your message remains legible and accessible when using this approach.

 **Accessibility Note**

Avoid using images with text, as screen readers are not able to read text within images. Learn more about [creating accessible images](#).



# Using Graphics

## Cropping the City Grid for Different Aspect Ratios

Each part of the graphic has a distinct look, lending versatility to any set of communications.

Place the city grid into the size frame you need, scale up (if necessary), and move it around until you find a crop that works for your communication.

Here are some examples of how you can crop the city grid graphic.

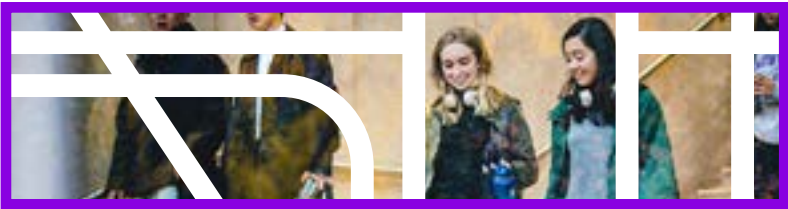
16:9 Presentation



1:1 Social post



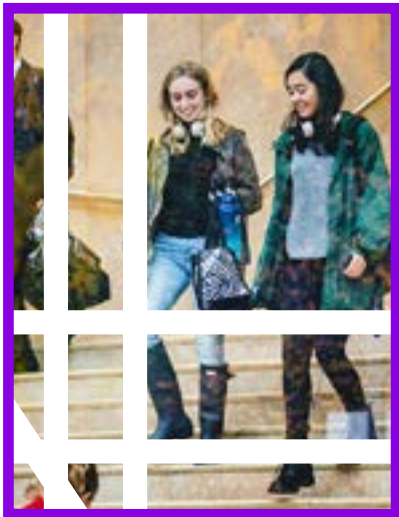
4:1 Email or web banner



9:16 Social post



8.5" x 11" Flyer

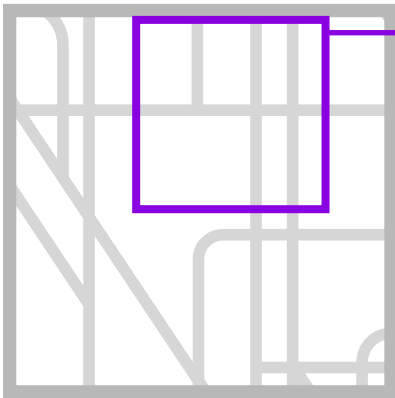


# Using Graphics

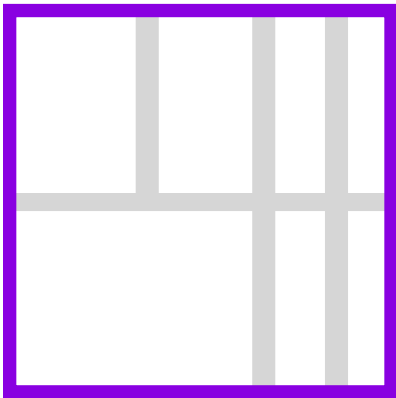
## Tips for Cropping and Scale

### Scale

Zoom in to decrease the amount of shapes and lines. Always show at least one intersection, diagonal, or curve.



Scaled down cropping shows more of the grid and has a lot of energy.



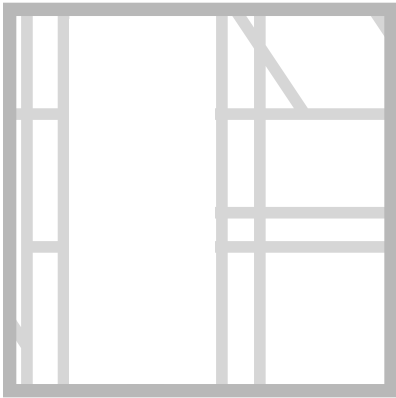
Scaled up cropping feels more calm and creates room for text.

### Create White Space

Delete any shapes or lines that don't work with your design and/or to create room for text or images.



Before



After

### Line Weight

The line weight should stay in relative proportion to the size of your communication. It should be thick enough to highlight a detail or subject but not so thick it overpowers it.



Here the line is too thin to have any real impact on the design.



Here the line is perfectly proportioned to give a sense of vibrancy, impact, and movement.



Here the line feels too heavy and bulky, crowding the person it is highlighting.

### When to Crop

Don't use the entire city grid graphic in designs with fixed aspect ratios. It must be cropped. Larger portions of or the entire grid can be used in responsive digital applications.



Do not use the entire city grid in fixed designs.

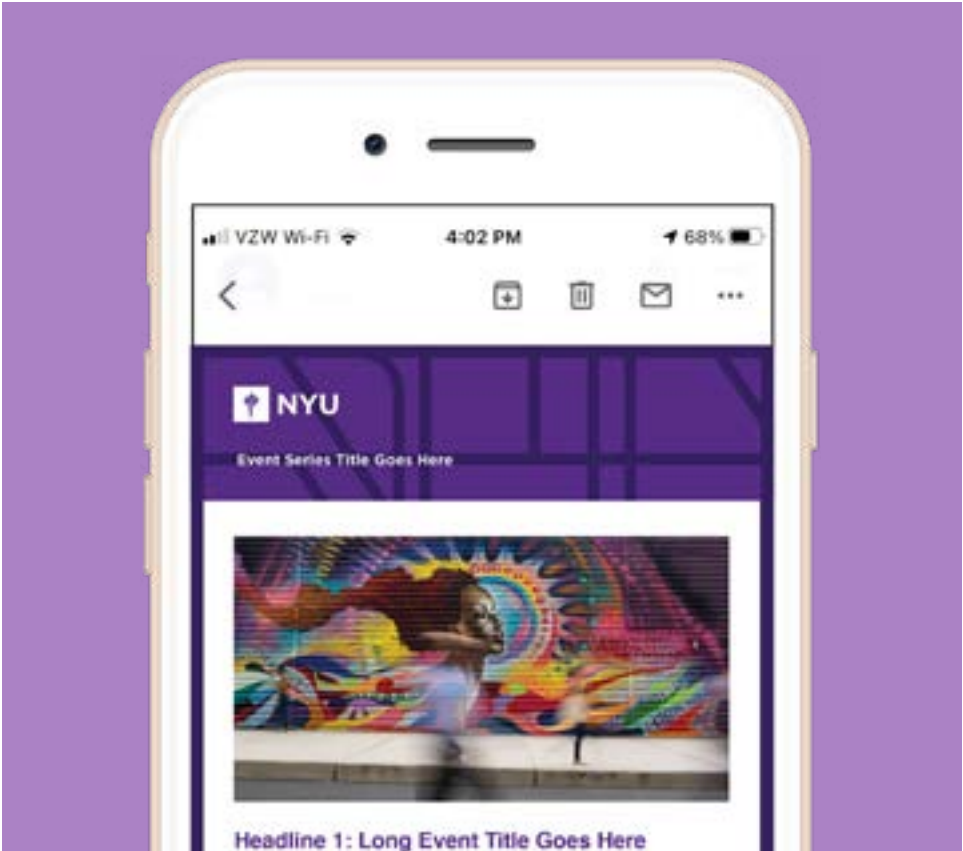


Never let the edges of the city grid show, even in responsive designs.



# Using Graphics

## Putting It All Together



### Email

The NYU logo is in the top-left corner to reinforce brand recognition. A darker, cropped version of the city grid pattern is used for the email masthead. A path anchors the title of the event series. The border of the email, which extends vertically on both sides of the message as the recipient scrolls through the email content, is also a part of the city grid.



### Window Decal

The way this decal bridges both windows tells a story. The Ultra Violet frame is left open at the top and encompasses both the professor and student. A single path unites the two windows and connects the text. Additional parts of the city grid pattern are subtly overlaid around the edges of the composition to create a greater sense of focus on the center.



### Book Spread

A single path weaves its way through this book spread to carry the reader through the composition. The headline on the left-hand page is anchored to the path and sits over a subtle city grid background. The path continues to the right, framing the body text and ultimately finding its way to the edge of the page, encouraging the reader to follow.

# Iconography

While NYU does not have a standard iconography style, it is important to aim for visual consistency when creating icons for designs.

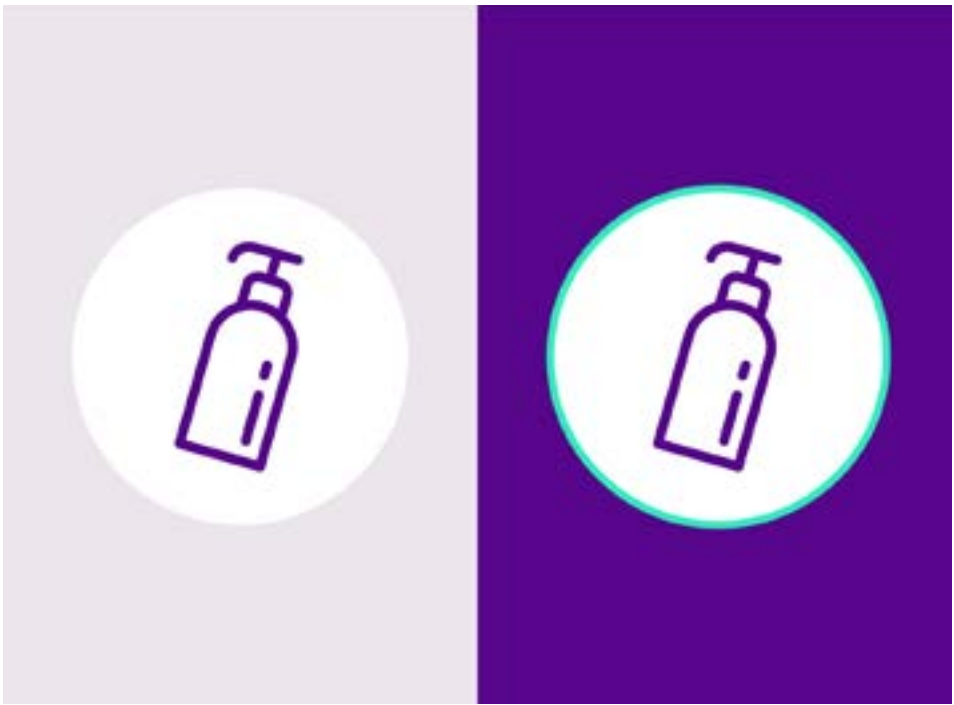
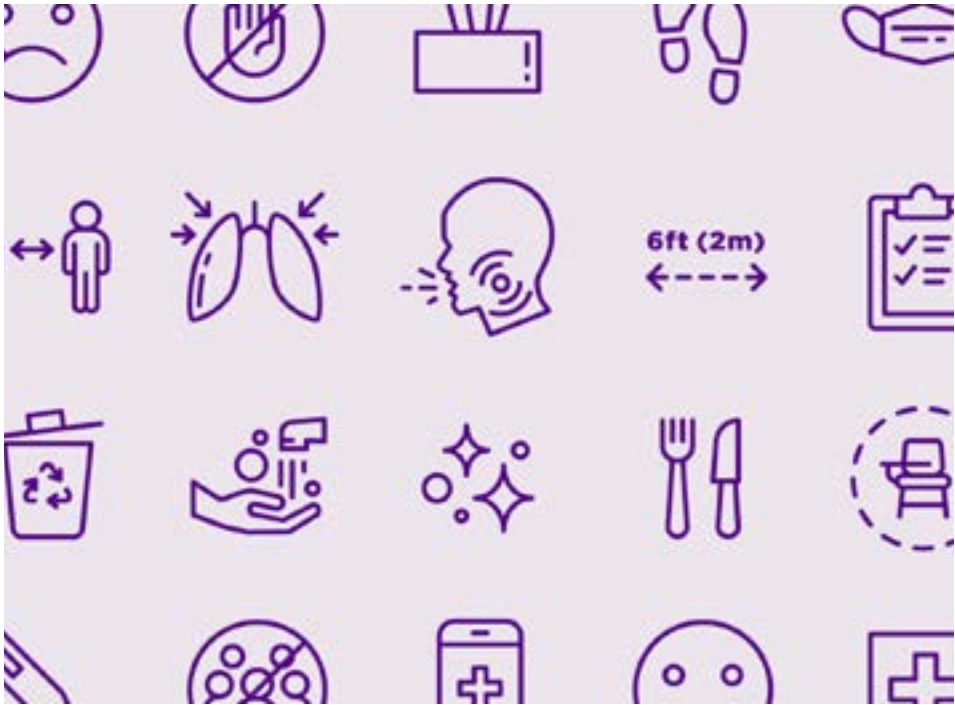
Iconography is a great way to convey information in a visually appealing way. Icon styles range from thin lines to thick glyphs, sharp to rounded, and everything in between. Pick and stick to a consistent style in order to make your designs feel more professional and cohesive. You can either create your own design system or source iconography from online resources like [Noun Project](#).

## Example: NYU Returns Icon Style

NYU Returns calls for consistent branding across multiple applications, such as signage, videos, web, and social media. The visual system relies heavily on iconography to communicate quickly and effectively. Initially, an icon library was developed based on open-source icons. The style is contemporary—thin lines with rounded edges and end caps make the icons feel open and approachable. Knocking out strokes to show overlaps is another distinguishing stylistic choice.

### Accessibility Note

If icons are required to understand content, then they must have a contrast ratio of at least 3-to-1. Check your contrast levels with the [Colour Contrast Analyzer](#) and refer to page 67 for more information on color contrast.



OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# Photography



# Our Photography Style

**Photography is a powerful tool for conveying NYU's spirit, strength, and vibrancy. The right photograph will help bring your story to life and tie it to the University's larger narrative.**

Our photography style is street level and eye level to the viewer. We want the audience to feel like they are immersed in your story, whether it takes place out on the street or in a classroom. Aside from bold, establishing shots, we should never use photography that loses that sense of human scale.

New York City and our additional urban locations are full of life and big ideas. Our photography needs to capture that. We are a university of the curious and adventurous, and at its best our photography embraces the unexpected and inspires our audiences to dive deeper with us.

## NYU Photo Services and Galleries

The NYU Photo Bureau offers photographic services to the university community and curates a free stock image photo bank. (Refer to page 119 for more information.)

NYU Photo Bureau [↗](#)





# Environmental

## NYU and the City

NYU is part of the urban fabric no matter where you are in our global network. Our images should capture the colors, textures, and movement of the city in an inspiring and welcoming way.

It's important to maintain an authentic, street-level view of our urban homes. Approach city photography as a photojournalist, looking for smaller moments that bring the human side of the city to life.

When using a grand, city skyline image, consider coupling it with a more intimate, human-focused moment or urban detail.

 **Accessibility Note**

Remember to add **alt text** to each image you use online. You can mark purely aesthetic images as decorative (if the platform supports it). To learn more about image accessibility, check out [Using Accessible Images and Graphics](#) and Digital Communication's [CMS Training and Support image component tutorial](#).





# Establishing Shots

An establishing photo introduces the story you’re telling. It sets the scene, establishes the tone, and presents the story’s bigger picture before diving into its details.



# Campus-Focused

This is your opportunity to place our audience at the center of it all. These photos give the viewer a glimpse of what it feels and looks like to live, work, and study within the NYU global community. Be sure to include people within the context of our buildings and campus. We want to avoid making our urban homes feel empty and unapproachable.





# Topical

Candid, documentary-style images contextualize your communication.

Use straight-forward angles to keep your viewer immersed in the story. While not necessary, including out-of-focus foreground elements can create the illusion of depth and make the viewer feel as if they are part of the scene.

Focus on the people to maintain the humanity in your story. Whenever possible, avoid the sole individual. Instead, focus on moments of connection between subjects.

Capture smaller moments within a crowd to allow your photo to be more accessible and relatable.



## Permissions

Anyone featured prominently in NYU photography must sign a media release form that grants the University legal permission to use their image.

Download our [Media Release Form](#) and refer to the [Release Form Best Practices](#).



# Classroom

Photographs of our classrooms should capture authentic interactions and should never feel staged or forced. Be sure to focus on moments of collaboration but don't lose awareness of the setting. No matter what the subject, our classroom images need to show our students and faculty within their proper context. Photography is one of the most powerful tools to showcase the curious and driven spirit that is alive and well within our classrooms.



# Events

While there is a wide range of events at NYU that vary in their levels of energy and activity, it's important to remember that you are still telling the story of the event through photography. Resist the desire to stage a shot. If it's a performance or a game, be sure to capture the movement and excitement. If it's a formal affair, focus on the genuine interactions between the guests.





# People

With 15 global locations and a community that represents over 140 countries and more than 100 languages, NYU sits at the crossroads of the world. The photography you choose should help tell that story.

## Permissions

Anyone who is fully identifiable in your images must sign a media release form.

Download our [Media Release Form](#) and refer to the [Release Form Best Practices](#).





# Portraits

**Our portraits should clearly illustrate the diverse people and perspectives that make up NYU. A great portrait is determined by two factors: personality and environment.**

Place your subject in a setting that helps bring them to life; pursue an honest, relaxed image that allows your subject’s personality to shine through; and use natural light from windows whenever possible. In addition to helping the subject feel comfortable, this will help tell their story, giving the audience a better understanding of who they are, and lend their portrait a sense of humanity and relatability.

Avoid using a flash and an overly posed, rigid setup.

We want the people we’re highlighting to feel comfortable and appear open and approachable.





# Capturing Personality

A great portrait is all about the personality. Strive for images that help bring the subject to life. Instead of overly posed, rigid setups, attempt to capture a portrait that is honest and engaging. We want the people we’re highlighting to feel comfortable and appear relatable.



# Establishing Environment

Placing your subject within an environment that helps tell their story goes a long way. It gives your viewer a better understanding of who they are.





# Tips for Photo Editing

Here are some tips to help make your images more compelling and in line with the NYU brand.

**Note on resolution:** Always use high-resolution images and make sure they appear crisp. For digital environments, resolution should be at least 72 dpi; for print, 300 dpi.



## Lighting

Avoid harsh direct light. Use natural and indirect light when possible.



## Saturation

Bump up the saturation and contrast of your image to convey a dynamic, bold, and confident feel.



## Cropping

Crop your images to remove any unnecessary visual information and bring focus to your subject.



## Angles and Distortion

Images should be street or eye level and straight on. Avoid distortion and weird angles.

OUR VISUAL EXPRESSION

# Video



# Effective Storytelling Through Video

Video can be an effective and powerful way to promote our mission and vision while highlighting the impact NYU has on the world. Like all communications, videos produced by any individual or group at NYU should be of the highest quality to properly represent the institution and its identity.

## Permissions

Anyone featured in an NYU video, including interviewees and other identifiable individuals, must sign a media release form permitting the University to use their image and/or voice in recordings.

Download our [Media Release Form](#) and refer to the [Release Form Best Practices](#).





# General Suggestions

NYU videos should...

Tell a complete and compelling story as concisely as possible (in general, storytelling web videos should be approximately three minutes or less)

---

Be consistent in style, tone, and message

---

Follow the university brand standards and visual identity guidelines

---

Record clear, understandable audio

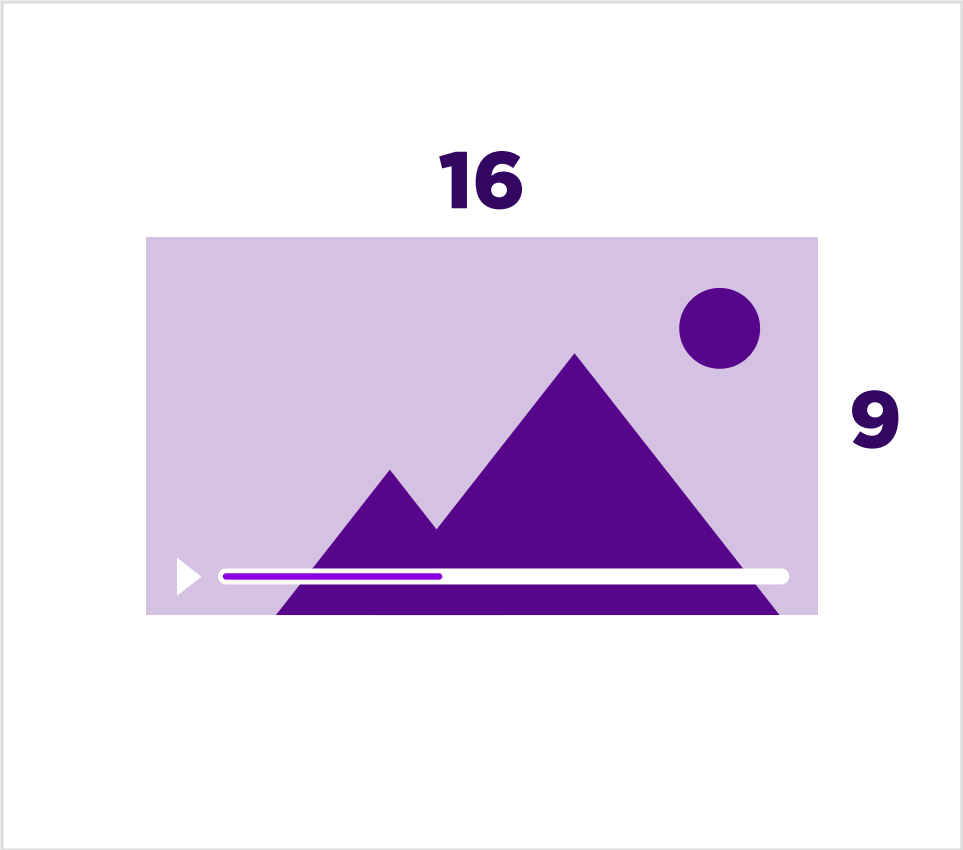
---

Meet the NYU Website Accessibility Policy standard for [video captioning](#)

---

Close with the appropriate NYU logo or lockup

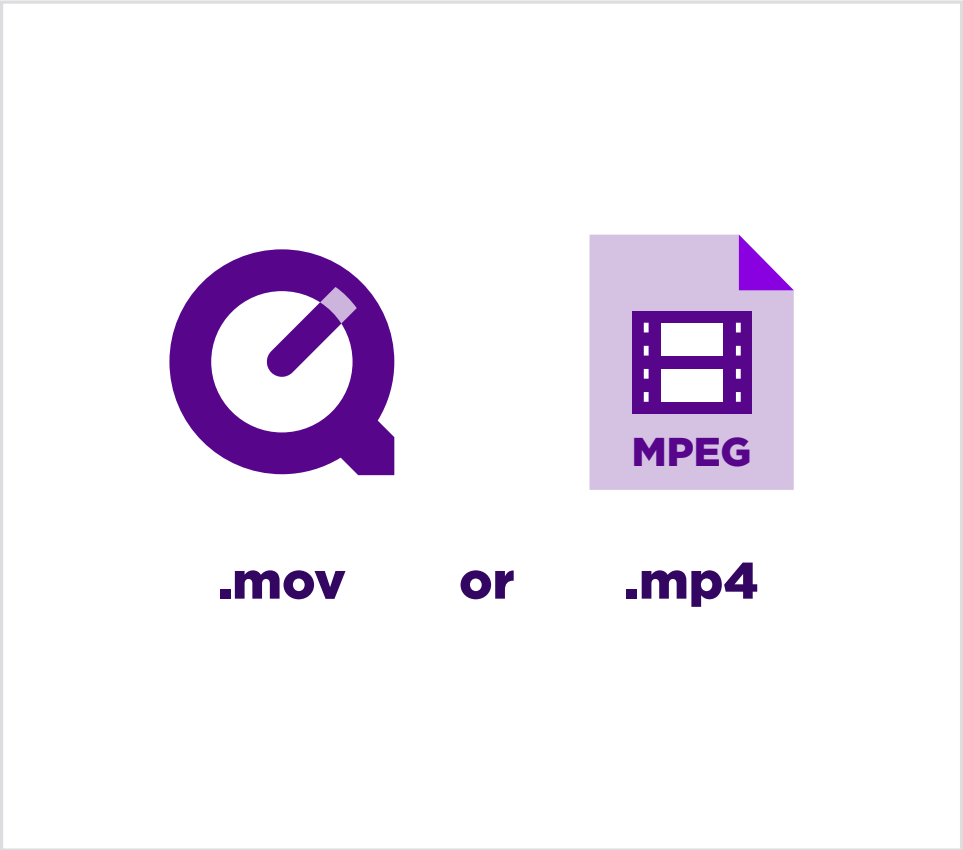
# Technical Standards



## Aspect Ratio

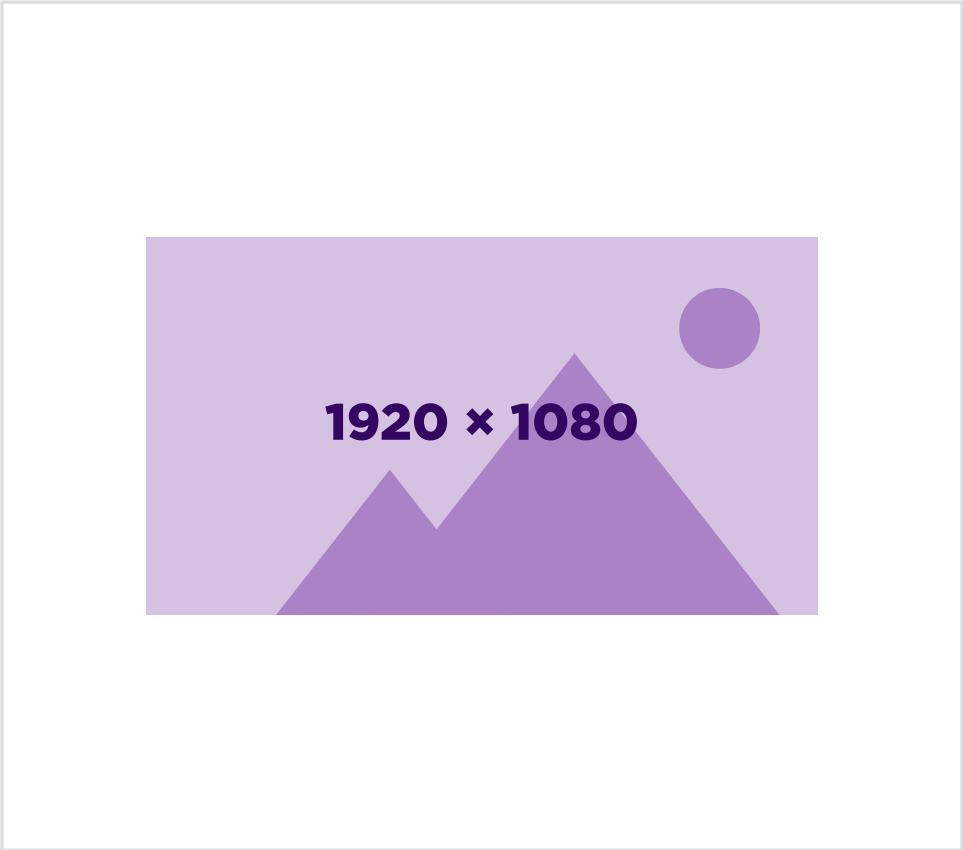
The recommended aspect ratio is **16-to-9**.  
Some social platforms may require different aspect ratios.  
Consider how you will use your footage *before you film it*.

For more information, check out the social media best practices at [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).



## Video Format

The preferred file types to upload to most online platforms are **QuickTime (.mov)** and **MPEG (.mp4)**.



## Resolution

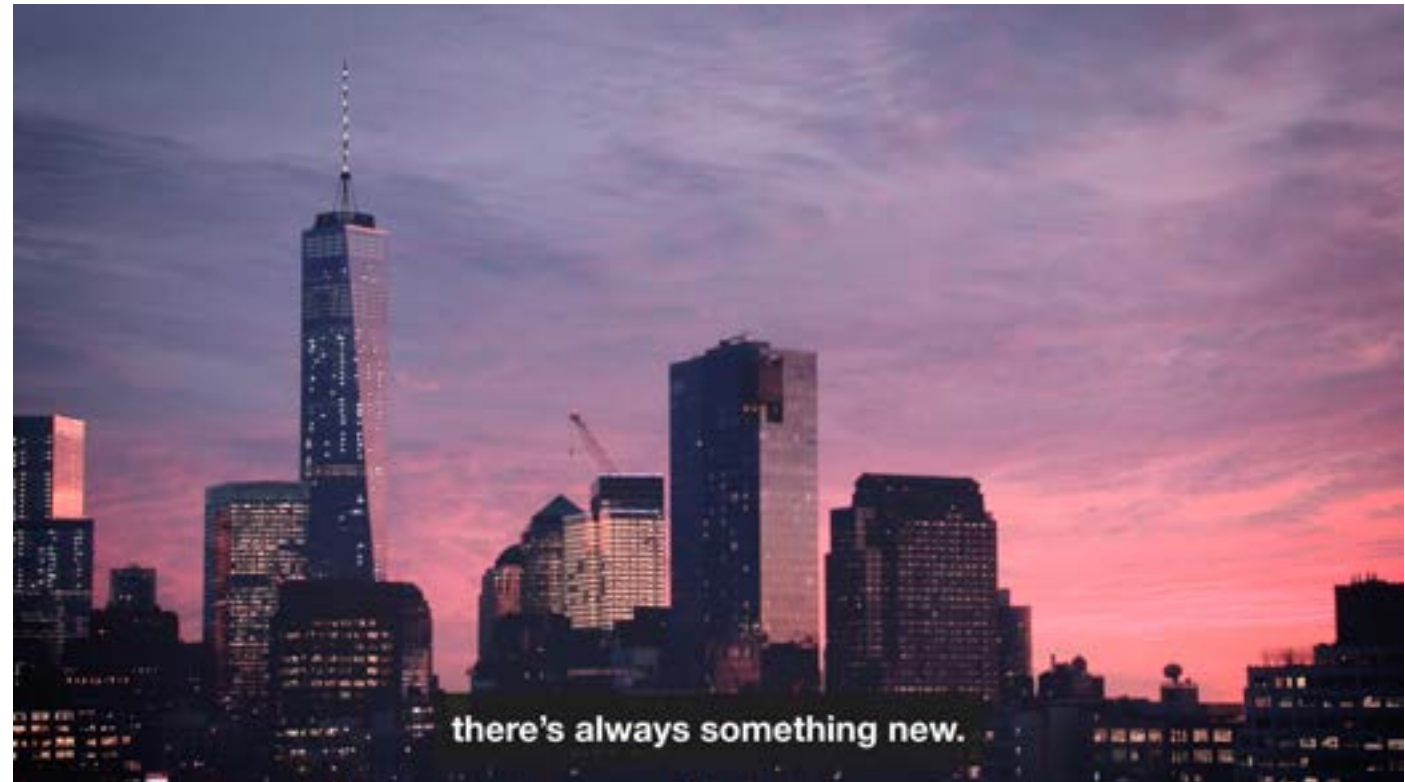
Footage should ideally be filmed at **4K** to ensure flexibility when editing, but **1080p (high definition)** is also acceptable.  
Export video at high definition or higher.

# Accessibility: Closed Captioning

**NYU is legally required to make all our digital resources accessible. This includes ensuring that our videos work for people with visual and hearing impairments.**

**Closed captioning** is an on-screen/visual transcription of the video's audio portion. Many video platforms, such as YouTube, offer automatic captioning, but this can often have errors, especially when the audio quality is low. It's important to check and edit automatic captioning or have a professional service transcribe your video. For additional resources, please refer to Digital Accessibility's [How-to Guide for Captions](#).

**Readability** is important. To ensure people can easily read words you put on the screen, keep the variety of devices people may use in mind. Many people consume video on mobile devices, so always test your videos on a smartphone and adjust the caption size accordingly.



# Lower Thirds

A lower third is a graphic overlay that introduces and identifies a subject featured in a video. It includes the individual’s name and title in a title-safe area of the screen.

The lower third should be included on the subject’s first speaking appearance. Exceptions include:

- If the first scene of the interviewee is less than two seconds, wait until the next longer clip to introduce the subject in order to give the viewer enough time to read and process the name and title.
- If the first scene is a close-up, wait to place the lower third on a medium or wide shot.



## Lower Third Templates

Download branded lower third templates from [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).

# Identifying Subjects

Identifying subjects in a video is important to provide context and credibility. Given space and legibility constraints, it is best to keep the title descriptor concise. If a faculty member holds multiple titles, use the one that is most relevant to the video. **When identifying students**, omit their last name(s) in order to maintain their privacy.

Always identify the interviewee in the following order:

**Line 1:** Name (Alumni Designation[s]\*)

or Name (NYU School 'XX)

**Line 2+:** Title, Organization

\*Visit our [editorial guide](#) for updated alumni designations.



# Placement

The lower third can be placed on the left or right side of the frame, depending on which has the most empty space. When possible, place in-line with or below the shoulder of the subject and include consistent padding between text and background bar.

Make sure the placement does not interfere with the shot. Avoid obstructing important information and covering the interview subject.

## Accessibility Note

Make room for closed captioning by placing the lower third—and any other text—high enough on the screen. As a general rule, keep the bottom eighth of the screen clear, but it’s important to always test the video with captions.





# Examples of Lower Third Treatments



# Ending a Video

All videos should conclude with a version of the NYU logo or a lockup, and—if appropriate—videos should include end credits as well.

While the beginning of a video sets its tone, the end is an opportunity to provide additional information and branding that adds credibility to the content.

## End Credits

Use end credits to acknowledge others involved in the production of the video, including partners and sponsors. They should appear after the main content is finished and before the closing slide. It may be appropriate to use end credits for videos that include:

- Science research footage provided by students, faculty, and/or other institutions
- Unlicensed music that has permission of use at no charge or requires attribution
- Sponsorships/partnerships—for instance, when an organization outside of your department or school was a partner for the content



## Closing Slide

The recommended closing slide features the widely recognized NYU logo expression. Using a unit lockup is also acceptable, provided they are consistent with overarching NYU brand guidelines.

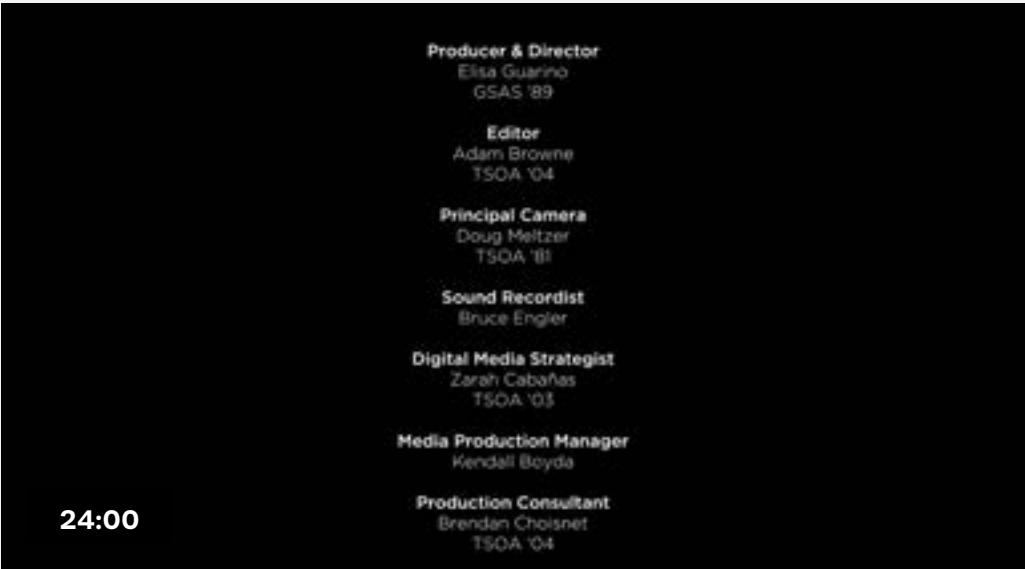
In most cases, use a simple dissolve or fade-out transition to introduce the logo or lockup. However, if the video has a fast, upbeat tone, a transition is not needed. In either case, the ending transition should fit with the tone of the video. Avoid animating the logo or lockup in order to maintain consistency across all videos.





# Examples of Video Closing Sequences

With End Credits | NYU Stonewall at 50 Documentary



Without End Credits | NYU Welcome Day Highlights



# IN ACTION

## In this section:

Manager's Toolkit

Wasserman Identity

Social Media Post

Email Templates



Project

# Manager’s Toolkit

Unit

Office of Work Life

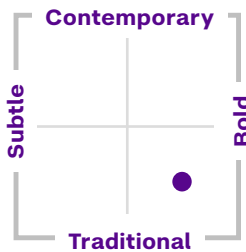
**Scope**

Upon returning to the office, NYU Work Life developed a toolkit to help managers navigate a successful transition from virtual to in-person management. The toolkit ultimately consists of an interactive PDF document and rollout presentation deck.

**Visual Elements**

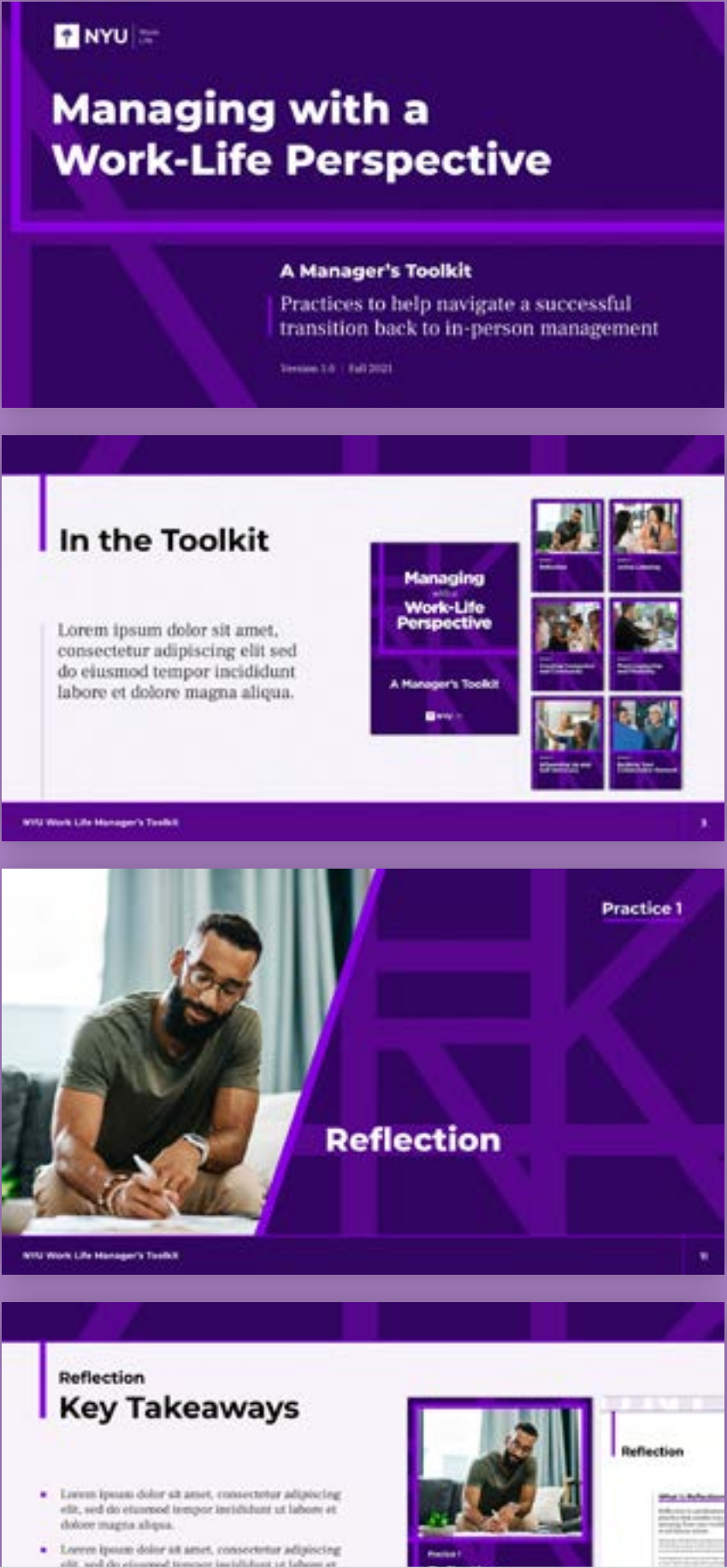
Work Life wanted a design that felt approachable and established, so a traditional/bold tone was the best fit. Deep violet is used generously to lend seriousness to the piece, while a majority of the pages use plenty of white and light violet to make the content feel airy and approachable. Ultra Violet accents are use sparingly to keep the piece feeling contemporary. Gotham Black headers were paired with Mercury body text. The city grid graphics were used as subtle backgrounds and page borders. Photography is vibrant and natural.

**Note:** This project was delivered when Gotham and Mercury were our primary typefaces.



 **Accessibility Note**

Remember to [remediate PDF documents](#) that you create before sharing them.



Project

# Wasserman Identity

Unit

Wasserman Center for Career Development

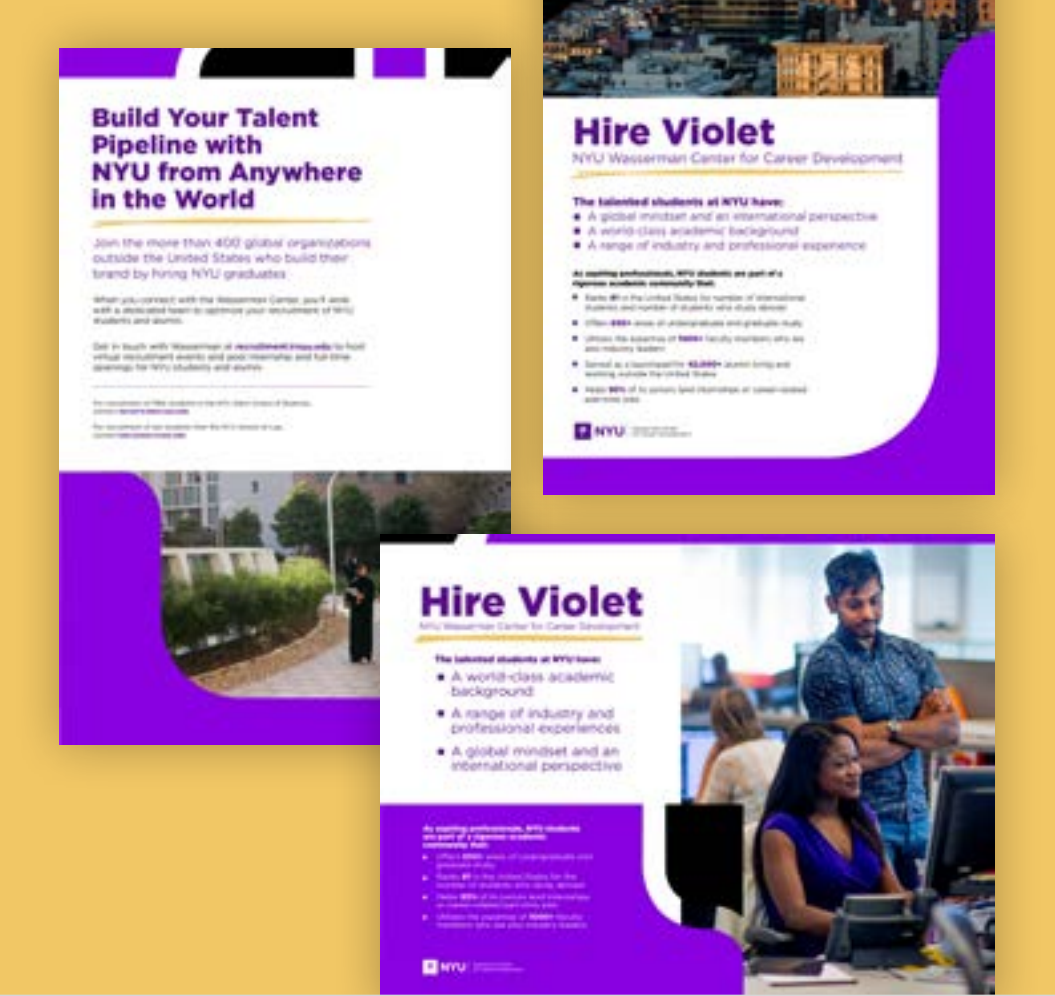
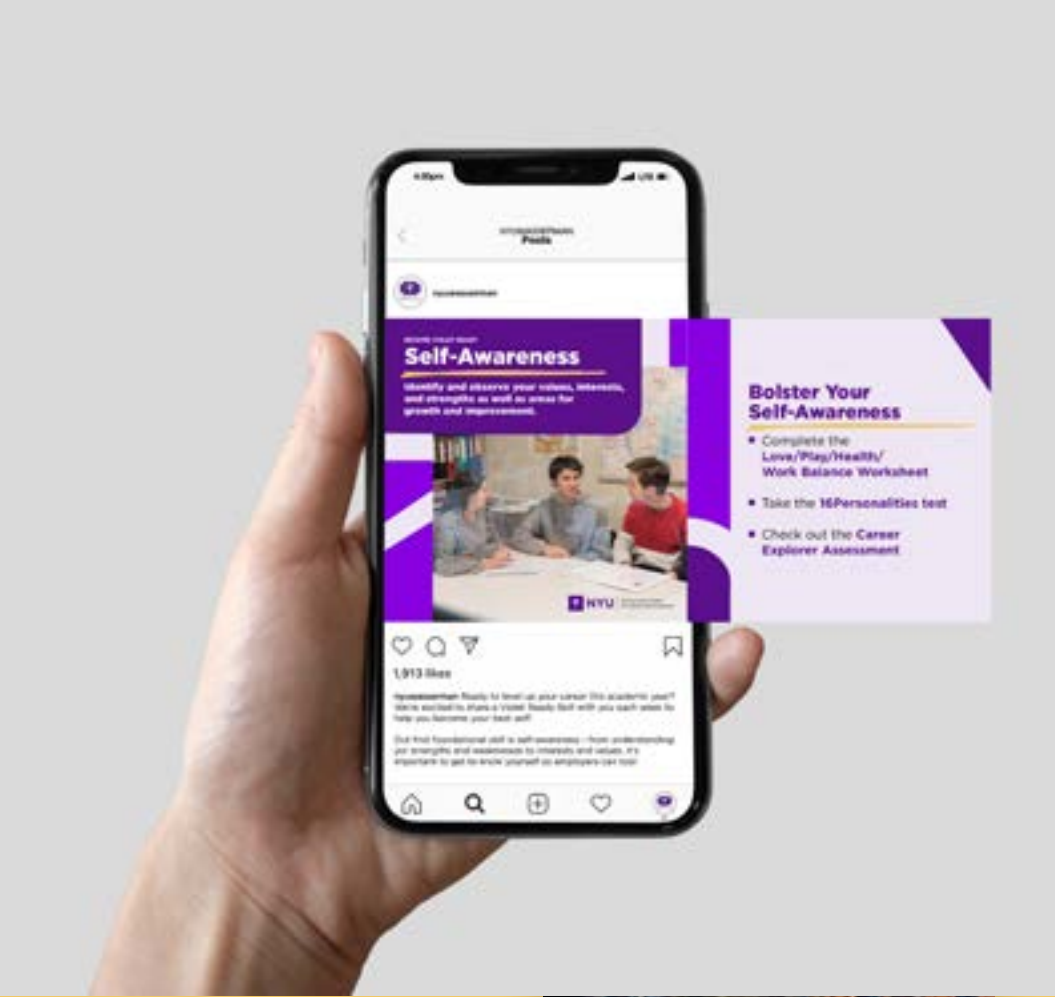
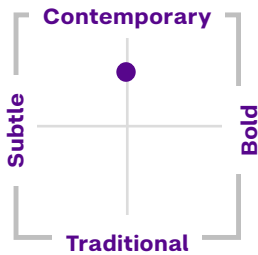
Scope

Reposition Wasserman and refresh its visual identity to expand its audience reach, establish more global partnerships, and further their mission to create career opportunities for students and alumni.

Visual Elements

The Wasserman Center’s visual expression supports and strengthens the Center’s brand identity, position, and essence of discovery and connection. The Center utilizes the city grid in a way that ties it to the University’s institutional visual identity while still differentiating itself from its peers in the career development space. The accent color, Wasserman Highlighter, is unique to Wasserman and allows audiences to quickly identify communications from the Center. The hand-drawn graphics bring a personal feel to the communications while simultaneously sharing the Wasserman Center’s warm and approachable personality. Through photography, viewers feel what it’s like to engage and work with the Wasserman Center.

**Note:** This project was delivered when Gotham and Mercury were our primary typefaces.





Example Project

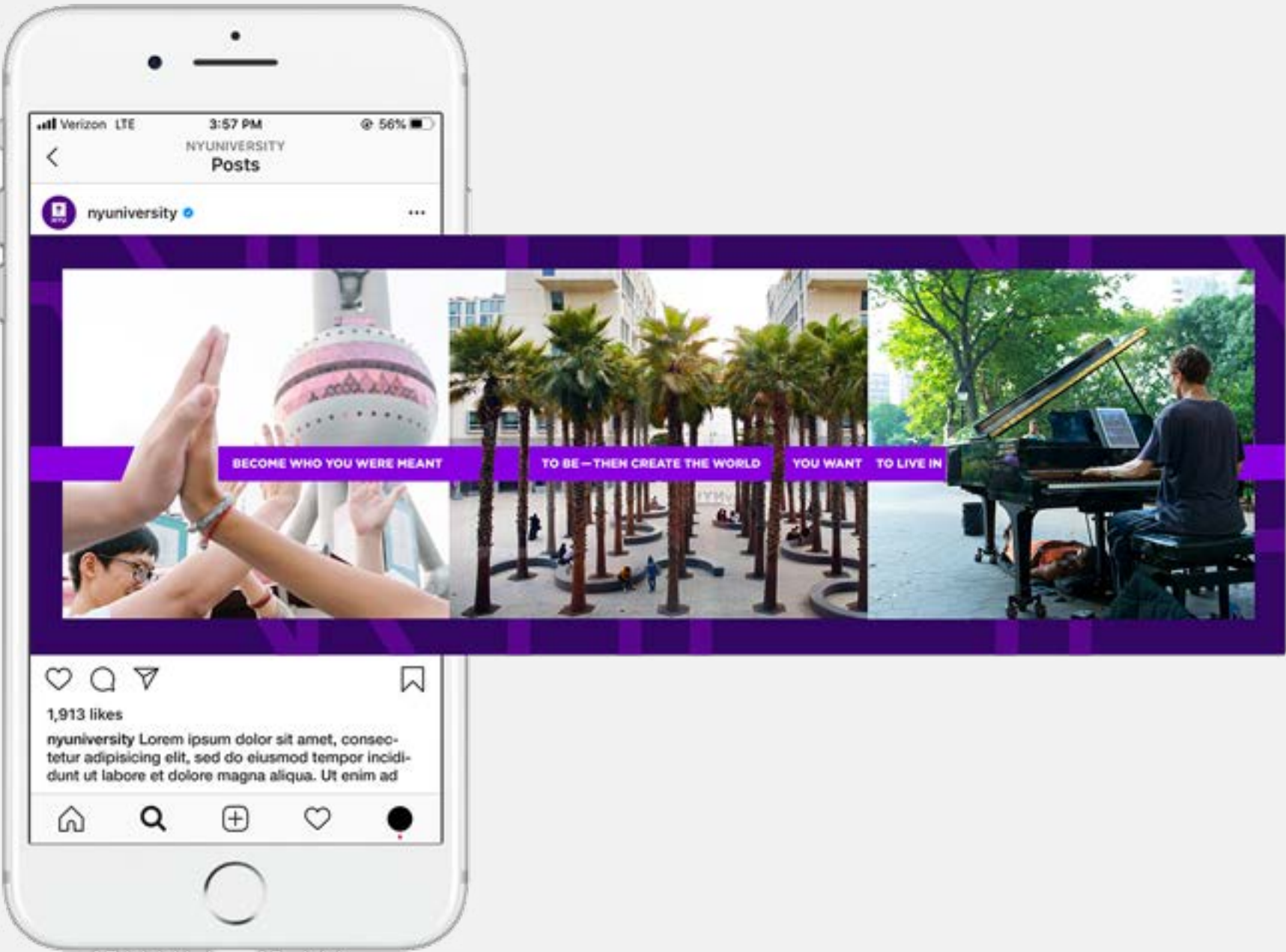
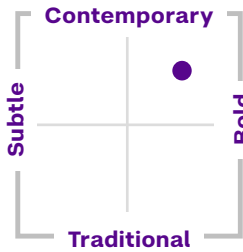
# Social Media Post

Scope

This example post highlights the connectivity between NYU’s three degree-granting campuses in Shanghai, Abu Dhabi, and New York City while suggesting a seamless academic or professional experience across cultural boundaries.

Visual Elements

An Ultra Violet path weaves through striking images of all three locations and is the perfect nesting place for inspired banner text. Bold, all-caps NYU Perstare typeface keeps the post contemporary. Using the NYU Violet city grid over a deep violet background gives this post some depth and achieves brand alignment.



Project

# Email Templates

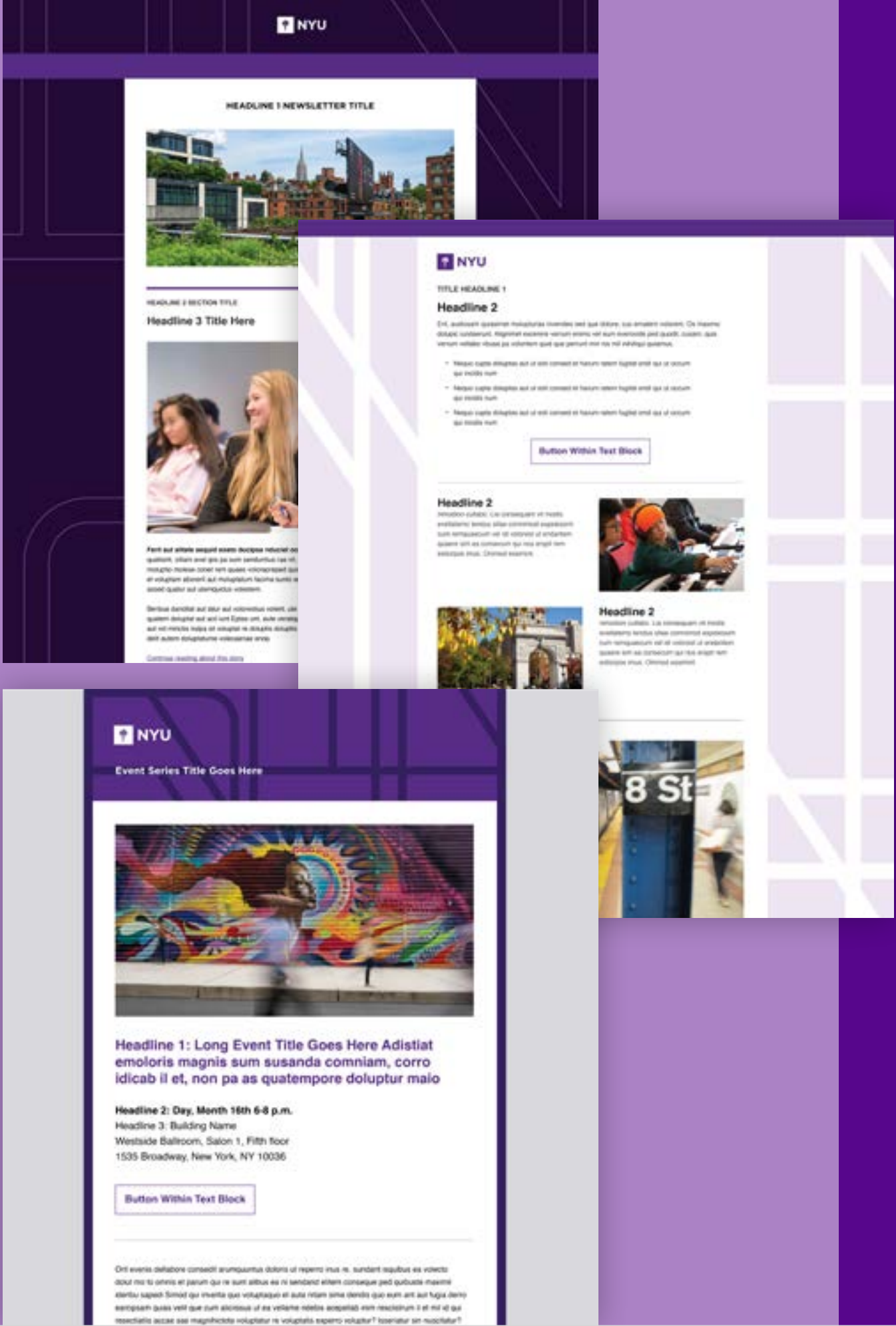
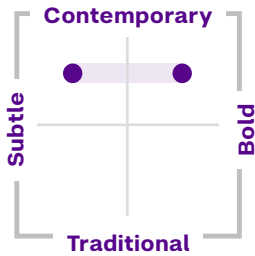
**Scope**

Develop a suite of email templates focusing on three types of email messages schools, departments, and offices send. The first design showcases sample newsletter content; the second provides flexibility for basic letter messaging; and the third contains promotional content for a single event.

To build email templates, partner with the Office of Digital Communications Email Direct team ([email.direct@nyu.edu](mailto:email.direct@nyu.edu)).

**Visual Elements**

The city grid graphic provides texture to the background while the main content section remains open to allow space for various messaging needs. We use Arial, a web-safe font, when designing emails and appropriate header styles to align with accessibility standards. The templates are mobile responsive, so the content will reflow to fit a variety of screen widths. The visual tone of the templates ranges from contemporary/subtle to contemporary/bold. The deep violet background and NYU Violet path anchored to the top of the newsletter template (top left and top right) make it feel bold.





# BRAND SUPPORT SERVICES

## In this section:

Design, Content, and Creative Strategy

Digital Accessibility

Digital Experiences and Web Applications

Global Inclusion, Diversity, Belonging, Equity, and Access (GIDBEA) Related to Branding and Communications

Photography

Printing

Public Affairs

Video

# Design, Content, and Creative Strategy

## Marketing Communications

### Creative Services

Centrally located within the Office of University Relations and Public Affairs, the Office of Marketing Communications (MarComm) is a creative agency that has helped tell the NYU story for decades. MarComm utilizes strategic content development and tailored creative design to produce engaging, informative, actionable, and integrated marketing campaigns.

■ Discover how MarComm can [help you tell your story](#).

### Editorial Guide

At NYU, we unify under one voice. In general, NYU Marketing Communications follows the [Chicago Manual of Style Online](#) and [Merriam-Webster](#). This guide covers our print and digital editorial style as well as our word preferences. While it is a great place to start, it is not comprehensive. If you have editorial questions, please contact [urpa.styleguide@nyu.edu](mailto:urpa.styleguide@nyu.edu).

Log in with your NetID to access the editorial guide.

■ Read our [editorial guide](#).

### Creative Brief Template

A creative brief is an important tool when starting any creative project. A good brief will outline background information, goals, audience, deliverables, and more. Marketing Communications provides an editable creative brief template in Google Docs for the NYU community to use and revise to fit their needs. Log in with your NetID to access the creative brief template.

■ Use our [creative brief template](#).

### Google Workspace Templates

Refer to our design templates on [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand) for more information on Google Workspace and getting started with NYU's Google Docs templates.

■ Check out our [Google Workspace templates](#).

# Digital Accessibility

## Information Technology

Digital accessibility is the practice of ensuring that NYU websites, web applications, and digital content can be used by our community members who have a diverse range of hearing, movement, sight, or cognitive abilities.

NYU is committed to supporting an information technology environment that provides individuals with disabilities an equal opportunity to participate in the University’s programs, benefits, and services as their peers without disabilities. This resolve is grounded not only in NYU’s commitment to the inclusion of all members in its community but in the knowledge that accessible digital content generally enhances usability for everyone.

To this end, NYU will undertake efforts to make its websites and digital content accessible to all participants in the University’s programs and activities, including students, faculty, administration, and staff.

■ Explore resources related to [digital accessibility](#).

### General Resources

- [Websites: Images and Alt Text](#)
- [WebAIM: Alternative Text](#)
- [World Wide Web Consortium Contrast \(Minimum\) Understanding SC 1.4.3](#)
- [Colour Contrast Anayzer \(TPGi\)](#)
- [Digital Accessibility: Creating accessible PDFs](#)

### Accessibility Resources Throughout These Guidelines

#### Logos

- All-university logo alt text (page 36)
- Degree-granting campus lockup alt text (page 37)
- School lockup alt text (page 38)
- Global academic center and program lockup alt text (page 40)
- Office lockup alt text (page 42)
- Color contrast for logos and lockups (page 44)
- University seal alt text (page 51)

#### Color

- Color contrast (pages 61 and 67)

#### Typography

- Typographic hierarchy (page 74)

#### Graphics

- Layering text over graphics (page 85)
- Avoid using images that contain text (page 85)
- Color contrast for iconography (page 89)

#### Photography

- Alt text for imagery (page 92)

#### Video

- Closed captioning (pages 104 and 105)



# Digital Experiences and Web Applications

## Digital Communications

The Digital Communications Group provides essential web services and support for NYU faculty and staff.

### Web

The team owns NYU.edu, the University’s central web property and content management system (CMS). All central administrative units and some schools use the CMS to create and maintain their web presence. To help users achieve a successful web presence, Digital Communications provides tutorials and training, site architecture assistance, web design and development, support for the University Events Calendar, and web page content reviews.

### Email

The team runs the Email Direct service that helps users send email blasts and subscription-based messaging to the university community.

### Mobile App

Digital Communications maintains NYU's official mobile app, NYU Mobile. The app features targeted content for students, staff, and faculty. The team also provides instruction and support for schools and units that wish to develop their presence in the app.

### User Experience

The team offers user-centered research, design, and strategy services to help staff and faculty understand their audience and improve the usability of their web presence. Digital Communications also partners with the University’s UX Advisory and Advocacy Group to create a consistent user experience across all NYU products and services.

Learn more about [Digital Communications](#) and request help with a project.

# Global Inclusion, Diversity, Belonging, Equity, and Access (GIDBEA) Related to Branding and Communications

Office of Global Inclusion, Diversity, and Strategic Innovation

NYU’s commitment to building and strengthening a university-wide GIDBEA culture led to the creation of the Office of Global Inclusion, Diversity, and Strategic Innovation (OGI). OGI provides expert consultation, resources, and innovative strategies to help guide the University—and its uniquely global and diverse communities—toward a more inclusive future.

- For more on GIDBEA in the context of branding and communications, refer to the Content Strategy at [nyu.edu/brand](https://nyu.edu/brand).
- Still have questions? [Contact OGI](#).

## Photography

### NYU Photo Bureau

#### Photo Services

The NYU Photo Bureau offers photographic services to the university community, including portrait sessions, event photo shoots, copyright/licensing, stock photo purchases, and photo archiving. Photo Bureau photographers can be booked for photo assignments on campus, within New York City, nationally, or on any NYU degree-granting campus.

- Browse the Photo Bureau’s [full list of services](#).

#### Photo Bureau Galleries

The Photo Bureau curates a free stock image photo bank that contains imagery ranging from student life to campus locations. The Photo Bureau regularly updates its galleries based on internal projects, requests, and presidential initiatives. Images may be used for NYU communications including social media, internal presentations, websites, and videos.

- Request access to the [Photo Bureau galleries](#).

## Printing

### NYU Reprographics

NYU Reprographics has evolved into a full-service shop providing a variety of media services such as copying, printing, graphic design, and document imaging. Reprographics strives to provide exemplary customer service along with excellent pricing.

- [Reprographics print services](#)

### i-Buy NYU

i-Buy NYU is the University’s system for requisitioning, supplier payment, and the procurement of goods and services.

- [i-Buy NYU services](#)

# Public Affairs

## NYU Public Affairs

### Public Affairs

Through communication with the news media and the external community, the Office of Public Affairs is dedicated to supporting the strategic goals of the University: recruiting the best faculty and the best students and cultivating the University’s research and teaching-and-learning enterprises.

■ Learn more about [public affairs at NYU](#).

### Publications

NYU offers a variety of media, such as newsletters and magazines, to help current students, alumni, and New Yorkers stay in touch with the latest news and developments at the University.

■ Browse [NYU’s publications](#) and get [press contacts](#).

### Social Media

Public Affairs also manages NYU’s central social media channels, which reach a combined audience of over 1.5 million students, faculty, staff, alumni, and other community members. They offer guidelines, best practices, and tips for starting an NYU social media account as well as training, support, and a Social Media Directory.

■ Learn more about [social media at NYU](#).

# Video

## NYU Media Production

### Video Production

NYU Media Production is the University’s full-service video production unit creating effective and memorable content for NYU’s many audiences. Media Production specializes in numerous types of content including long- and short-form videos for social media, prospective students, current students, alumni, trustees, and donors as well as videos honoring NYU people featured at events large and small. The department also conducts oral histories. The Media Production team has adapted workflows to accommodate current social distancing measures, including remote production.

■ Explore NYU [Media Production’s services and showcase of work](#).

### Video B-Roll Packages

Media Production offers B-roll packages for all NYU media-makers. To access the B-roll packages below, input the login password when prompted: **nyumedianyu**.

The B-roll request form can be found at the bottom of this collection.

■ Log in to access the [video B-roll packages](#).

